U. S. DEPARTMENT OF LABOR
JAMES J. DAVIS, Secretary
CHILDREN'S BUREAU
GRACE ABBOTT, Chief

SIXTEENTH ANNUAL REPORT OF THE CHIEF OF THE CHILDREN'S BUREAU TO THE SECRETARY OF LABOR

FISCAL YEAR
ENDED JUNE 30
1928

UNITED STATES
GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE
WASHINGTON
1928

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SIXTEENTH ANNUAL REPORT

OF THE

CHIEF OF THE CHILDREN'S BUREAU

UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF LABOR,
CHILDREN'S BUREAU,
Washington, September 15, 1928.

Hon. JAMES J. DAVIS,
Secretary of Labor.

SIR: I have the honor to transmit herewith the sixteenth annual report of the Children's Bureau, for the fiscal year July 1, 1927, to June 30, 1928.

The Children's Bureau was created by act of Congress in 1912, the importance of a Federal research organization in the field of child welfare having been presented to Congress by both President Roosevelt and President Taft. In the 16 years that it has functioned as a fact-gathering bureau public and private agencies interested in the care of children and individual parents have increasingly made use of the information that has been painstakingly and dispassionately assembled by the scientific staff of the bureau.

As this and previous annual reports show, most of the local studies made by the bureau have been undertaken at the request of State departments, official and unofficial children's code commissions, child-health committees, associations for the prevention of crime and delinquency, and agencies caring for dependent children. Within the limits of its resources the bureau has sought to make the information assembled available in printed reports and popular bulletins, films, exhibits, and news summaries and to a limited extent by the loan of personnel for consultation and demonstration.

MATERNITY AND INFANCY

Administration of the maternity and infancy act.

With the passage of the maternity and infancy act in 1921 the bureau was enabled to cooperate with the States in the development of an educational program for the promotion of the health of mothers and babies. Last year accordingly is the sixth that the maternity and infancy act has made available to the States funds for this purpose. Throughout the year 45 States and the Territory of Hawaii were cooperating with the Children's Bureau in accordance with the terms of this act to promote the welfare and hygiene of maternity and infancy. The legislatures of three States—Connecticut, Illinois, and Massachusetts—have never accepted the benefits offered by the Federal Government.

Table 1 gives the amounts available and the total amounts accepted by the States from the appropriations for the fiscal years 1922, 1923, 1924, 1925, 1926, 1927, and for 1928 up to June 30. As the appropriations are available for a 2-year period a full report on the 1928 appropriation can not be made until June 30, 1929.

TABLE 1.—*Amounts available to States and Hawaii from Federal maternity and infancy funds and amounts accepted* [1]

[Statement as of June 30, 1928]

States and Territory cooperating	Maximum amounts available from 1922 appropriation [2]	Amounts accepted by States from 1922 appropriation	Maximum amounts available from 1923, 1924, 1925, 1926, 1927, and 1928 appropriations	Amounts accepted by States and Hawaii [3] from—					
				1923 appropriation	1924 appropriation	1925 appropriation	1926 appropriation	1927 appropriation	1928 appropriation [4]
Total	$477,500.00	$316,554.02	[3] $1,201,725.96	$716,333.40	$877,122.04	$932,754.69	$947,959.59	$977,866.97	$919,075.78
Alabama	10,297.56	10,297.56	25,836.95	25,836.95	25,836.95	25,836.95	25,836.95	25,836.95	25,836.95
Arizona	5,753.88	5,000.00	12,253.71	5,000.00	12,253.71	12,253.71	5,000.00	12,253.71	12,253.71
Arkansas	8,953.03	5,000.00	21,817.51	6,855.75	16,817.51	13,500.00	14,000.00	12,000.00	21,817.51
California	12,731.12	(5)	33,112.01	24,279.35	13,114.93	15,620.00	26,730.00	23,941.58	29,130.00
Colorado	7,119.83	5,000.00	16,337.20	9,976.99	9,999.33	9,999.37	10,000.00	10,000.00	5,000.00
Connecticut	8,114.75	8,114.75	19,311.48	9,655.74					
Delaware	5,503.10	5,503.10	11,504.01	11,504.01	11,504.01	11,504.01	11,504.01	11,504.01	11,504.01
Florida	7,184.90	5,000.00	16,531.72	8,621.28	16,531.72	16,531.72	16,531.72	16,531.72	16,531.72
Georgia	11,533.10	6,750.00	29,530.55	11,000.00	15,250.00	28,490.00	29,530.00	29,530.55	29,530.55
Hawaii			[3] 11,725.96			11,725.96	9,933.93	11,725.96	11,725.96
Idaho	5,974.30	5,000.00	12,912.66	6,250.00	7,912.66	5,691.60	9,308.40	6,000.00	7,500.00
Illinois	19,631.03	(5)	53,739.10						
Indiana	11,611.07	8,199.09	29,763.62	24,995.00	26,250.00	25,750.00	25,000.00	25,000.00	25,000.00
Iowa	10,423.56	10,423.56	26,213.60	26,213.60	26,213.60	26,213.60	26,213.60	26,213.60	26,213.60
Kansas	8,991.51	8,991.51	21,932.52	12,097.33				16,800.00	20,000.00
Kentucky	10,452.00	10,452.00	26,298.64	26,298.64	26,298.64	26,298.64	26,298.64	26,298.64	26,298.64
Louisiana	9,057.50		22,129.80		17,590.60	22,127.79	21,664.27	22,129.80	5,000.00
Maine	6,732.66		15,179.77					15,000.00	5,000.00
Maryland	8,270.49	7,913.57	19,777.05	19,277.05	19,269.05	19,164.58	19,277.00	19,277.00	19,277.00
Massachusetts	13,691.06		35,981.70						
Michigan	13,276.07	13,253.97	34,741.11	34,741.11	34,741.11	34,741.11	34,741.11	34,741.11	34,741.11
Minnesota	10,385.44	10,385.44	26,099.65	26,099.65	26,099.65	26,099.65	26,099.65	26,099.65	26,099.65
Mississippi	9,039.70	9,039.70	22,076.58	22,076.58	22,076.58	22,076.58	22,076.58	22,076.58	5,000.00
Missouri	12,679.67	12,473.15	32,958.19	28,527.38	21,762.17	24,000.00	25,000.00	32,958.19	30,000.00
Montana	6,238.31	6,238.31	13,701.91	13,701.91	13,701.91	13,701.91	13,700.00	13,700.00	13,700.00
Nebraska	7,924.66	7,924.66	18,743.21	17,661.69	7,409.50	11,915.00	12,980.00	11,000.00	11,000.00
Nevada	5,174.63	5,000.00	10,522.06	5,000.00	10,522.00	10,522.00	10,522.00	10,522.00	10,522.00
New Hampshire	5,999.61	5,000.00	12,988.31	5,000.00	12,988.31	12,988.31	12,988.31	12,988.31	12,988.31
New Jersey	12,119.83	12,119.83	31,284.55	31,284.55	31,284.55	31,284.55	31,284.55	31,284.55	31,284.55
New Mexico	5,812.96	5,812.96	12,430.33	12,430.33	12,236.40	12,430.33	12,430.33	12,430.33	12,430.33
New York	28,429.70		80,041.78		80,041.78	80,041.78	80,041.78	80,041.78	80,041.78
North Carolina	10,773.47	10,773.47	27,259.66	27,259.66	27,259.66	27,259.66	27,259.66	27,259.66	27,259.66
North Dakota	6,459.36	5,000.00	14,362.74	6,000.00	6,000.00	8,300.00	8,300.00	7,200.00	6,500.00
Ohio	17,993.41	7,187.95	48,843.46	11,900.00	17,297.89	26,606.96	31,400.73	32,500.00	5,000.00
Oklahoma	9,575.88	5,000.00	23,679.48	5,000.00	20,934.06	23,679.17	23,679.48	23,679.48	23,679.48
Oregon	6,767.35	6,232.61	15,283.46	8,000.00	15,283.46	15,283.46	11,966.83	15,283.46	15,283.46
Pennsylvania									

Oklahoma	6,767.35	6,232.61	15,283.46	8,000.00					
Oregon									
Pennsylvania	24,672.69	24,667.12	68,810.99	68,810.20	68,810.99	68,810.99	68,810.99	68,810.99	68,810.99
Rhode Island	6,363.54		14,076.28		4,999.86	14,076.28	14,076.28	14,076.28	14,076.28
South Carolina	8,798.54	8,797.50	21,355.65	21,355.65	21,355.65	21,355.47	21,355.65	21,355.65	21,355.65
South Dakota	6,436.07	6,436.07	14,293.11	12,844.24	14,272.92	13,451.18	14,285.10	5,000.00	5,000.00
Tennessee	10,274.35	5,000.00	25,767.55	18,521.94	22,410.73	25,767.55	25,767.55	25,767.55	24,035.00
Texas	15,520.41	9,363.93	41,450.52	32,567.38	40,689.20	40,447.84	35,350.52	35,350.52	41,450.52
Utah	6,013.85	5,000.00	13,030.89	6,365.00	13,000.00	13,000.00	12,279.23	13,000.00	13,000.00
Vermont	5,795.09	(5)	12,376.90		2,775.33	4,281.36	4,937.38	5,000.00	5,000.00
Virginia	10,209.61	10,209.61	25,574.00	25,574.00	25,574.00	25,574.00	25,574.00	25,574.00	25,574.00
Washington	8,060.58	4,998.70	19,149.55	10,000.00	10,000.00	10,000.00	10,000.00	5,000.00	5,000.00
West Virginia	8,302.16	5,000.00	19,871.74	5,000.00	10,000.00	10,000.00	19,871.74	19,871.74	19,871.74
Wisconsin	10,938.04	8,995.03	27,751.62	27,750.44	27,751.62	27,751.62	27,751.62	27,751.62	27,751.62
Wyoming	5,438.57	4,998.87	11,311.12	5,000.00	11,000.00	6,600.00	6,600.00	7,500.00	5,000.00

[1] Under the terms of the act each State accepting receives $5,000 outright; an additional $5,000 is available to each State if matched; the balance of the appropriation is distributed among the States, if matched, on the basis of population. Amounts shown as accepted are the amounts actually accepted by the States less refunds of unexpended balances returned to the Federal Treasury as of June 30, 1928.

[2] Owing to the fact that only a few months of the 1922 fiscal year remained at the time the appropriation act for that year was passed a full appropriation was not made.

[3] The benefits of the act were extended to Hawaii on March 10, 1924. No appropriation therefore was available to that Territory in 1923 and 1924. The total amount available to the States in each year from 1923 to 1928 has been $1,190,000.

[4] These funds are available until July 1, 1929. Actual acceptances up to June 30, 1928, are given here.

[5] California and Illinois accepted the full amount available, and Vermont accepted $5,000. However, these funds were not spent but were returned to the Federal Treasury.

A full report of the work which this Federal fund has made possible is published each year by the Children's Bureau. Only a very brief summary of the accomplishments of the past year can be given here. The reports submitted by the States for the fiscal year 1928 show continued expansion and improvement in the work being done. Its extent during the past year is indicated by the fact that the work was carried on in 2,070 counties. The child-health and prenatal conferences have continued to be used in every State as a means of parental education in the hygiene and welfare of maternity and infancy. In the year under review 7,341 combined prenatal and child-health conferences, 2,002 prenatal conferences, and 18,839 child-health conferences were conducted by the cooperating States. In addition to assisting with the conferences and class work, 390 county nurses who gave full or part time to maternity and infancy work and the nurses on the State staffs reported making 686,964 home visits, helping the mothers to plan for better prenatal care for themselves and scientific care for their infants and preschool children. The number of expectant mothers reported reached during the year through conferences, instruction in classes, home visits, prenatal letters, and correspondence courses was more than 150,000. A larger number of infants and preschool children were reached through conferences, instruction to parents, and home visits, more than 1,013,000 being reported.

Each year some counties have assumed responsibility for maternity and infancy work initiated or assisted by the States, thus putting the work on a permanent basis. Since the beginning of the States' cooperation under the maternity and infancy act 162 counties have assumed responsibility for maternity and infancy work that had been begun with State and Federal funds. In 1928 103 combined prenatal and child-health centers, 17 prenatal centers, and 190 child-health centers—a total of 310—were established.

The medical and nursing staff of the maternity and infant-hygiene division of the Children's Bureau made 33 visits to States during 1928 to confer with State administrators and to review types of work in different communities within the States. The bureau accountant made the usual visits to the 45 States to audit accounts.

At the request of States 29 staff details were made for special work. For example, the bureau's colored physician has spent the year in 2 Southern States assisting in the instruction of colored midwives; a nurse was assigned to conduct demonstrations in maternity and infancy work in 2 States; the bureau's consultant in obstetrics conducted a graduate course in obstetrics in 1 State, and the consultant in pediatrics gave a similar course in another State; in 8 States physicians were assigned for maternal-mortality studies; and at the request of the United States Bureau of the Census and the State departments of health bureau agents have helped in birth-registration campaigns in 4 States since admitted to the birth-registration area, which at the end of the year under review comprised 42 States and the District of Columbia.[1]

With the funds made available by the Federal Government there has been a steady expansion of activities conducted by the States, an annual increase in the number of permanent locally supported county

[1] Colorado and South Carolina have been admitted since July 1, making 44 States in the area as this report goes to press.

nurses, and an increase in the State appropriations. With a better understanding of the causes of infant morbidity and death the old fatalistic attitude is being supplanted by the desire for scientific information as to the care of children, so that books, pamphlets, lectures, and classes on child care are everywhere in demand.

In the report of the administration of the maternity and infancy act for 1927,[2] which concluded a 5-year period of Federal and State cooperation, the accomplishments are summarized and some of the results of local pieces of work are appended to the State reports.

The annual conference of the State directors of maternity and infancy work has been an important factor in developing a better understanding of maternity and infant hygiene, of methods of cooperating with local communities, of ways of interesting parents, and of the practical problems involved in office administration. The fifth annual conference was attended by representatives of 43 cooperating States and of 3 States that have not accepted the benefits of the maternity and infancy act. Members of both the consulting committee on pediatrics and the consulting committee on obstetrics of the Children's Bureau attended the conference and took part in the program and discussions. The conference was opened by the Secretary of Labor on April 2, 1928. The first three days of the conference were devoted to discussion of such subjects as care during delivery and confinement, reduction of the maternal mortality rates in rural districts of certain States and of the infant mortality in rural districts of other States, methods of approach to the neonatal period and the preschool period, and general administrative problems. At the invitation of Dr. Howard Childs Carpenter, the representative of the American Child Health Association on the bureau's consulting pediatric committee, the fourth day, April 5, was spent in Philadelphia visiting the Children's Hospital. On the morning of April 6, 15 representatives of States and of the bureau who are at work on the maternal-mortality investigation returned to the Children's Bureau for a round-table discussion of field and statistical problems relating to the study.

Infant mortality in the United States.

For a number of years the general trend in infant mortality in the United States birth-registration area has been downward. Interruptions in this general trend, fluctuations above and below the general level, occur from time to time which are often due to causes not affected by a child-hygiene program. According to advance figures for the calendar year 1927 reported by the United States Bureau of the Census for the States and the District of Columbia which were in the birth-registration area in that year and the preceding year, 1,862,773 babies were born alive and 119,681 babies died in 1927, as compared with 1,856,068 live births and 136,118 infant deaths in 1926. This great saving of the lives of babies made the infant mortality rate the lowest in the history of the United States—65 deaths per 1,000 live births for the birth-registration area in 1927 as compared with 73 for the area in 1926.

[2] The Promotion of the Welfare and Hygiene of Maternity and Infancy—The Administration of the Act of Congress of November 23, 1921, for Fiscal Year Ended June 30, 1927. United States Children's Bureau Publication No. 186. Washington, 1928.

The following 21 States had in 1927 an infant death rate lower than that for the registration area:

Alabama	64	Iowa	55	New York	59
Arkansas	61	Kansas	55	North Dakota	63
California	62	Kentucky	61	Ohio	62
Connecticut	59	Minnesota	52	Oregon	48
Idaho	50	Missouri	60	Utah	46
Illinois	64	Nebraska	51	Washington	50
Indiana	59	New Jersey	61	Wisconsin	59

Though these rates reflect great progress no State has as yet reached the low level of New Zealand, where the rate was 39 in 1927. Idaho, Oregon, Utah, and Washington, however, have rates sufficiently low to lead to the hope that if the present resources and facilities are continued and developed it may yet be said that there are some States in which it is as safe to be a baby as in New Zealand.

A study of the causes of death among American babies shows that in the expanding United States birth-registration area since 1920 there has been a marked decrease in mortality rates for gastrointestinal conditions, and a slight decrease in rates for natal and prenatal causes. The rates for respiratory diseases and epidemic and communicable conditions have shown considerable variation but neither upward nor downward trend. The average annual rate of decrease from 1920 to 1926 in mortality due to gastrointestinal conditions was 6.9 per cent. The rates for natal and prenatal causes show an average annual decline during this period of 1.2 per cent. For each of these types of causes in which reduction has been effected the mortality rates show variation from year to year, being higher in some years than in the year previous, but the general tendency downward is definite and significant in each instance, though very slight in the rates from natal and prenatal causes. The decreases are unquestionably associated with the general improvement in public health, the establishment of child-health conferences, the development of prenatal clinics, the distribution of literature, and public education regarding the importance of breast feeding.

Maternal mortality in the United States.

It is too much to expect that the death rate among women in childbirth will show so general and substantial a reduction as does the infant death rate. Figures are available for 1927 for 34 States and the District of Columbia as this report goes to press. The maternal mortality rates (deaths from causes associated with childbirth per 10,000 live births) for States in the birth-registration area in 1926 and 1927, for which figures have been supplied by the United States Bureau of the Census, are as follows:

	1926	1927
California	56.4	57.6
Connecticut	57.6	55.3
Delaware	92.9	58.6
District of Columbia	77.4	86.3
Florida	106.9	109.9
Idaho	56.9	60.0
Indiana	64.8	65.7
Iowa	60.4	58.9
Kansas	69.7	63.1
Kentucky	58.4	49.4
Maine	66.9	79.5
Maryland	57.8	57.5
Michigan	67.2	68.0

	1926	1927
Minnesota	57.4	44.4
Mississippi	78.7	86.7
Montana	80.2	66.3
Nebraska	66.5	59.2
New Hampshire	75.7	64.8
New Jersey	57.6	62.6
North Carolina	88.3	65.6
North Dakota	42.9	51.0
Ohio	67.1	61.9
Oregon	59.0	63.6
Pennsylvania	63.7	64.0
Rhode Island	59.6	64.1
Vermont	67.2	72.6
Virginia	79.8	61.5
Washington	75.0	66.5
West Virginia	70.6	61.5
Wisconsin	59.6	52.8
Wyoming	93.4	87.2

The maternal death rate has decreased in 16 of these States, has remained practically the same in 2 (Maryland and Pennsylvania), and has increased in 12 States and the District of Columbia. The expanding birth-registration area makes any conclusions difficult as to the general maternal-mortality trend. For the States in the birth-registration area from 1917 to 1926 the rates for the periods 1917–1921 and 1922–1926 are shown in Table 2.

TABLE 2.—*Comparison of maternal mortality prior to operation of the maternity and infancy act (1917–1921, exclusive of 1918), with maternal mortality during the period of operation of the act (1922–1926) in specified States;*[1] *rates per 10,000 live births*[2]

State	Year of first cooperation	Maternal mortality rate		
		1917–1921	1922–1926	Percentage of increase (+) or decrease (−)
States beginning to cooperate 1922, 1923:				
California [1]	1922	74.6	62.7	−16.0
Indiana	1922	78.0	62.8	−19.5
Kentucky	1922	62.6	60.0	−4.2
Maryland	1922	73.3	60.2	−17.9
Michigan	1922	78.3	66.9	−14.6
Minnesota	1922	64.6	53.9	−16.6
New Hampshire	1922	70.5	69.1	−2.0
New York [1]	1923	63.5	58.0	−8.7
North Carolina	1922	86.8	82.2	−5.3
Ohio	1922	74.2	67.3	−9.3
Oregon [1]	1922	89.4	69.6	−22.1
Pennsylvania	1922	69.7	63.9	−8.3
Utah	1922	73.6	50.2	−31.8
Virginia	1922	80.0	72.1	−9.9
Washington [1]	1923	83.7	68.1	−18.6
Wisconsin	1922	57.8	57.3	−0.9
States not cooperating prior to 1925:				
Connecticut [3]	------	58.3	55.6	−4.6
Kansas [3]	1927	76.5	68.5	−10.5
Maine	1927	77.8	77.0	−1.0
Massachusetts	------	68.8	64.6	−6.1
Vermont	1925	71.5	72.1	+0.8

[1] States selected are those in the United States birth-registration area in 1917 with the exception of California and Oregon, which came into the area in 1919, and Rhode Island, which was dropped from the area in 1919 and 1920. The rates for the States are for 1922–1926 and 1917–1921, exclusive of 1918 (when the rates were influenced by the influenza epidemic), with the exception of California and Oregon, where the rates are for the periods 1919–1921 and 1922–1926, and for New York and Washington, where the rates are for the periods 1919–1922 and 1923–1926, as these States did not cooperate under the act until 1923.

[2] Source: U. S. Bureau of the Census.

[3] Connecticut cooperated under the governor's acceptance from Apr. 1, 1922, to Dec. 6, 1923, but discontinued cooperation thereafter. Kansas cooperated under the governor's acceptance from Apr. 1, 1922, to Sept. 22, 1923, and resumed cooperation in 1927.

In the States showing the largest reduction in the death rates special activities were undertaken in addition to general education as to what constitutes adequate prenatal and confinement care, which was carried on in all the cooperating States. A majority of the States showed greater reductions in the rural than in the urban area, State efforts under the maternity and infancy act having been directed especially to the rural problem.

There is no single cause of the high maternal death rate. Isolation, untrained midwifery, lack of appreciation of the importance of prenatal supervision and consequent failure on the part of many women to consult their physician during the early part of pregnancy, inadequate hospital facilities in many rural sections, and poor technique in some hospitals are among the causes. It is hoped that the investigation described in the next section will enable the States to attack the problem with more certainty that their programs have a factual basis. Most of the emphasis to date has been on prenatal care and elimination of the untrained midwife, and where intensive work has been done the death rate has been substantially reduced. Certainly in this field no more than a beginning has been made. To stop now would be to lose the harvest. There are no deaths more tragic than those of women in childbirth. American men and women will certainly want to leave nothing undone that will make motherhood less hazardous.

A study of the causes of maternal mortality.

An investigation of maternal mortality undertaken in each case at the request of the State board of health and the State medical society is under way in Alabama, Kentucky, Maryland, Michigan, Minnesota, Nebraska, New Hampshire, Oregon, Rhode Island, Virginia, Washington, and Wisconsin.[3] In these States physicians are interviewing the doctor, midwife, or other attendant at birth of every woman that has died in childbirth during a two-year period, and, when the woman had hospital care, securing her hospital record. The schedule being used was worked out by the obstetrical advisory committee of the Children's Bureau, the general plan having been proposed by the chairman of that committee and approved by the State directors at the third annual conference of maternity and infancy directors. In three States the medical investigators are members of the State staff; in the others they are physicians belonging to the Children's Bureau staff, who have been assigned to this work in nine States. Information concerning approximately 7,000 deaths will have been secured when the investigation is concluded in 1929.

It is of interest that in Great Britain, where the maternal mortality rate is also high but lower than in the United States, a plan for a similar investigation was outlined by the Minister of Health in support of the estimates he was submitting in the House of Commons on May 15, 1928. The problem in Great Britain, where the midwife is accepted as having a permanent and important part in the provision of obstetrical care, differs from that in the United States, where the midwife is in process of elimination and where the racial elements of

[3] Since July 1, 1928, plans for the study have been adopted in Oklahoma and North Dakota.

the population together with the great distances greatly complicate the problem, but conditions are sufficiently similar to make it worth while to quote some paragraphs from Mr. Neville Chamberlain's statement:

> I feel that the time has come when a great new effort ought to be made to bring down these figures of maternal mortality and to preserve the health of these mothers. There are many things we do not know yet about the causes of maternal mortality, but we do know something. We know that these figures, which persist, as I say, steadily throughout the country, nevertheless are not universal. There are places where we can find much lower figures. I think they will be found to be those places where there is the most careful antenatal and postnatal supervision and where the people themselves have had the greatest opportunity of learning what is necessary for them to preserve their health and the lives of their infants. The Ministry of Health is taking up this question very seriously. * * *
>
> I am now endeavoring to institute a new inquiry into the causes of maternal mortality. I am trying to enlist in that service the general practitioners throughout the country as well as the local authorities; and the British Medical Association have assured me that they are deeply interested in the question and that they will use all their influence with their members to get them to give every assistance possible to my inquiry. Under this scheme the local medical officer of health will make inquiry into every case of maternal mortality which occurs, wherever it may be, throughout the country. They will make this inquiry on lines which will be laid down by a committee at the Ministry of Health on the lines of that cancer committee which I have already quoted. Their returns will come in quarterly to that committee. They will be there examined, the information will be classified, and the committee will draw what conclusions they find it possible to draw from the information which they get; and all that information will then go back again to the local authorities and will be made known to those who are responsible for the conduct of the infant welfare centers and the maternity hospitals.
>
> * * * I must warn the committee that all these efforts are going to mean money * * *. If we can indicate with any confidence to the people of this country what are the precautions that it is necessary for us to take, if we are to remove this menace from our midst, I can not believe that the national conscience would allow the lives of the mothers of this country to be sacrificed merely for the sake of a few extra thousand pounds.[4]

Infant and maternal mortality in the District of Columbia.

A survey of infant and maternal mortality in the District of Columbia was made at the request of the Washington Council of Social Agencies and with the aid of the health officer of the District. The report includes statistical analyses of birth certificates and of infant and maternal death certificates in the District of Columbia and information secured through visits by a bureau physician to child-health and prenatal centers and to hospitals taking maternity cases. Material secured through questionnaires sent to hospitals and from printed reports was also utilized in determining what are the conditions in the District. Infant mortality rates for the individual years 1924, 1925, and 1926 and rates for the three-year period are compared with those for the birth-registration area and for Baltimore, Chicago, Detroit, New York City, and Philadelphia—cities that have 500,000 or more population and 2,000 or more colored births annually.

The study showed that the infant, stillbirth, and maternal mortality rates in the District of Columbia for the 3-year period, 1924 to 1926, were higher than those for the birth-registration area as a whole and higher than those for most of the cities under considera-

[4] Statement of Mr. Neville Chamberlain, Minister of Health. Parliamentary Debates, House of Commons, vol. 217, No. 64, Tuesday, May 15, 1928, pp. 895–898.

tion. The higher rates in the District were found to be due in part to the high infant and maternal death rates among the colored population. These were invariably higher than the rates for the colored population in the birth-registration area, as well as for the colored population of most of the cities whose statistics were used for comparative purposes. A larger proportion of both white and colored infants in the District were found to die from natal and prenatal causes than the white and colored infants of the birth-registration area as a whole, and the puerperal mortality rates for both white and colored mothers in the District were found to exceed the rates for mothers of the same races in the registration area and in every large city with similar racial elements in its population.

The central part of the city shows the highest death rate. The infant mortality rates for the three precincts of this part of Washington exceeded 100 per 1,000 live births in 1925. With this evidence of need for intensive work there was little provision for infant and prenatal care in this central district.

Among the recommendations made in the report were the following:

1. The establishment of child-health centers in all precincts having 500 or more births annually.
2. The establishment or expansion of municipal child-hygiene centers in precincts most needing improvement, as shown by high infant mortality rates and high stillbirth rates.
3. The establishment by the department of health of prenatal clinics in connection with child-hygiene centers in precincts showing large numbers of maternal and infant deaths, especially stillbirths and deaths within the first day of life.
4. An appropriation sufficiently large to permit expansion and improvement of the maternity service at Freedmen's Hospital, which has a very high maternal death rate.
5. The establishment of a maternity hospital in Washington taking only obstetrical cases.

The infant mortality rate for the District in 1927, which became available after the study was made, was 68, as compared with 85 for 1926. While this is a most encouraging reduction, the rate is higher than that for the birth-registration area, Chicago, New York, or Philadelphia. In contrast with the reduction in infant deaths the maternal death rate in the District increased from 77 per 10,000 live births in 1926 to 86 in 1927. That the District needs to give serious attention to this problem is clear.

CHILD HYGIENE

New Haven rickets study.

Work on the New Haven rickets study during the past year has been chiefly statistical. Analysis of the material collected in the three-year demonstration period is well under way. Children examined have been classified into two groups—the series and the nonseries. The children in the series group received their first examination at less than 6 months of age and were reexamined at frequent

intervals during the three years of the clinic demonstration. The number of examinations per child varied from 3 to 27, the average being 9 examinations. These children were given cod-liver oil of proved antirachitic value, and their mothers were advised as to its dosage and the need for sunshine in preventing rickets. They were also instructed regarding proper diets and health habits for the children. The children of the nonseries group received only one examination. Their ages ranged from 1 month to 5 years. This group consists of children who had had no special antirachitic treatment or health instruction, and the incidence of rickets in this group probably approximates that of the community.

The analysis of the material will include the relationship between clinical signs of rickets and X-ray evidence. Careful study will be made of the significance of the mildest forms of rickets, as well as the most severe and obvious forms, in relation to the general health and development of the child, his growth, nutrition, and diet. Cod-liver oil and sunlight, known to be the most significant factors in the cure of rickets, are being studied in relation to its prevention and control. Case studies of certain interesting groups of children are being made in addition to the statistical analysis.

The X rays taken of the children are serving as a basis not only for the diagnosis of rickets but also for a study of the ossification centers in the wrist. The development of the small bones of the wrist, which are spoken of as centers of ossification before they are fully grown, has been considered by certain writers in the last 25 years an indication of the degree of development or maturity of children. There have been numerous observations as to the age at which these centers appear, the order of their appearance, and the relation of their size and number to the sex, height, weight, and mental development of children. The New Haven rickets study has furnished a larger number of X rays showing these centers of ossification in children under 5 years of age than has been previously available for study, and they afford a valuable source for determining more exactly than has yet been done the time and order of appearance of the ossification centers of the wrist bones; that is, the beginning of the growth of the bone (ossification). At birth usually no wrist bones are apparent by X ray, because they are as yet not bone but cartilage, and hence not visible by X ray. X rays show that shortly after birth calcification, or ossification, begins in two of the wrist cartilages, and the bone continues to grow until maturity is reached. All the other ossification centers of the wrist (except one) may appear within the first five years, although many 5-year-old children have two or three centers still unossified.

In the analysis of the New Haven material the number of ossification centers present in the wrist has been studied in relation to age, sex, race (negro and white children), height, weight, and rickets. The New Haven material confirms previous findings that girls are definitely ahead of boys in the development of ossification centers. Negro children have been reported to be more advanced than white children in the development of ossification centers, but the New Haven group does not show this clearly. Height and weight, which are really biological indexes of maturity, are more closely related to the number of centers apparent in the wrist than the age of the child.

It is not clear that rickets has any effect on the appearance of ossification centers in the wrist, although marked rickets of long duration may retard their development. The actual time of appearance of the individual ossification centers varies considerably, but, in general, it is somewhat earlier than previous observers have estimated.

Porto Rico rickets study.

Statistical tabulation of the material from the Porto Rico rickets study is nearing completion. Some facts have been determined regarding the 584 children who were given physical examinations and of whose forearms X-ray photographs were taken. Approximately 50 per cent of these children were under 1 year of age, 40 per cent between 1 and 2 years, and 10 per cent between 2 and 3 years.

Of these 584 children, only 1 showed marked active rickets by X ray, 1 showed moderate healed rickets (until three months before examination this child had lived in New York City), 3 showed X-ray evidence of very slight rickets, which was definitely under control. Together these 5 cases make up nine-tenths of 1 per cent of the total number examined. The X-ray diagnosis for 70 children (12 per cent) was thought to be doubtful, that for 509 (87 per cent) was normal. On physical examination 400 children (68 per cent) showed no evidence of clinical rickets, 134 (23 per cent) showed some questionable signs, 46 (8 per cent) showed the physical signs of mild clinical rickets, 3 (one-half of 1 per cent) those of moderate rickets, and 1 (two-tenths of 1 per cent) those of marked clinical rickets. All the cases of mild clinical rickets had negative X rays. The one case of marked clinical rickets (a child who had always lived in an artificially lighted cellar) showed by X ray also severe active rickets without evidence of healing.

The nutrition of the children was on the whole only fair. Infants under 1 year who were breast fed were generally well nourished. Of 553 children whose diets were studied, 535 were known to be breast fed for a shorter or a longer period. At the time of examination 292 were not yet weaned. Of the 243 who had been weaned, 56 per cent were weaned before the end of their sixth month, 18 per cent between 6 and 12 months, 15 per cent between 12 and 18 months, 11 per cent at 18 months or later. Those over 1 year of age, whether breast fed or not, were not so well nourished as those under 1 year of age, and in many cases the nutrition was very poor. Of the 584 children examined, 56 per cent were well nourished and 31 per cent fairly well nourished, but 12½ per cent were poorly or very poorly nourished. Thirty-four per cent of the cases showed a greater or less degree of abnormal relaxation of muscle ligaments and joints and 48 per cent had pot bellies.

Though the children examined were in very large part free from rickets, they were not free from minor infections. Twenty-four per cent had enlarged tonsils and 23 per cent had enlarged cervical glands. Ninety per cent gave a history of previous colds and 64 per cent a history of gastrointestinal disturbances.

The diets of the children were carefully graded according to quantity of milk, eggs, fruit, vegetables, and starchy food. A summary of the diets for the first year of life of 477 children shows 205 (43 per cent) good or very good, 161 (34 per cent) fair, and 111 (23 per cent) poor or very poor. The diets for all or part of the second

year of life of those children over 1 year of age at time of examination were very much less adequate than those of the first year. The second-year diets of 210 such children showed only 4 (2 per cent) good or very good, 10 (5 per cent) fair, 26 (12 per cent) poor, 140 (67 per cent) very poor, and 30 (14 per cent) so extremely poor that an additional "out grade" was added to the others. The inadequacy of the children's diets after their first year is accounted for chiefly by the very small quantities of milk consumed and the great deficiency in eggs and green vegetables.

The diets of 532 mothers were studied and graded by a method based on the amounts of calcium and protein estimated as closely as possible from the actual diet eaten by the mother on the day before the interview. According to this scale, 10 per cent of these mothers had diets that were good, 40 per cent fair, and 50 per cent poor or very poor.

The inadequacy of the diets of both mothers and children, as gauged by standards set in the United States,[5] is striking and of great interest in view of the almost negligible amount of rickets found among the Porto Rican children.

There is no doubt that the children of Porto Rico receive a large amount of sunlight. Of those examined, 68 per cent were tanned by the sun, 88 per cent lived in houses that let in a large amount of sunlight, 10 per cent in houses that let in a fair or small amount of sunlight, and 2½ per cent in houses that were dark. Estimates based on information supplied by the mothers show an amount of outdoor life that was considered good for 58 per cent of the children under 5 months of age, for 72 per cent of the children between 5 and 9 months, and for 66 per cent of the children over 9 months of age. A fair amount of time was spent out of doors by the majority of the other children.

Analyses of the growth of the children in relation to diet, rickets, and sunlight are being made and will be included in the report.

Neonatal-mortality study.

The importance and need of a systematic study of the causes of death and sickness of children in the neonatal period (i. e., during the first month of life) is evidenced by the trend of the infant mortality rates in recent years in the United States birth-registration area and the comparative lack of knowledge of the causes of death in this period. Statistics show that the infant mortality rate as a whole (deaths under 1 year) has been definitely falling for the past 10 years, while the rate for the first month of life has fallen very little, so that more than half the deaths under 1 year occur in the first month of life (53 per cent for the years 1922-1926 in the birth-registration area). The actual causes of death in the neonatal period are often not determined, and hence most of the deaths during the first month are assigned in the vital statistics to obscure and indefinitely stated causes such as premature birth, congenital debility, and "other diseases of early infancy." In areas where the infant mortality due to gastrointestinal conditions and epidemic diseases has been greatly reduced attention should be focused on this earliest period of

[5] Sherman, Henry C.: Chemistry of Food and Nutrition, pp. 515–547. Third edition. Macmillan Co., New York, 1927.

life. Until the causes of sickness and death in this period are better understood intelligent plans can not be made for a further reduction of the death rate.

An investigation has been undertaken by the bureau to secure certain basic facts with reference to neonatal deaths. A preliminary study to work out methods and schedules was begun in January, 1928, with the cooperation of the pediatric, obstetrical, and pathological departments of the Yale School of Medicine. At the close of the fiscal year 1928, 100 newborn infants had been examined on the first day of life and reexamined approximately on the third, the tenth, and the forty-second day, and they will be reexamined at 1 year of age. In order that the data may be subject to statistical analysis schedules have been prepared on which to record the details of these examinations and the family, prenatal, natal, and postnatal histories. Effort has been made to include all data that may possibly throw light on any of the obscure illnesses of this period. Complete pathological studies were made of the eight infants of this preliminary series who died. During the coming year this study will be continued and the scope gradually broadened to include groups of infants born under differing conditions.

Stillbirths and neonatal mortality in Minneapolis.

In cooperation with the University of Minnesota the bureau has undertaken the tabulation and analysis of approximately 1,000 autopsies of stillborn and live-born infants made by Dr. Fred L. Adair of the faculty and his associates. The material includes gross and microscopic autopsy findings, the history of the mother's previous pregnancies, the history of the pregnancy resulting in the child that came to autopsy, and the history of the labor and puerperium. Special emphasis is placed upon the prenatal care received and upon the relationship of observations during pregnancy to the autopsy findings. Comparison of autopsy findings with cause of death, as shown upon death certificates, should throw some light upon the problems connected with the large number of deaths during the first month of life.

Chelsea posture study.

The report of the two-year posture study in one of the schools in Chelsea, Mass., has been completed and will go to press in the fiscal year 1929. It analyzes the results of posture training in a group of elementary-school children who did not differ from other children in the school except that they were given special training in posture in addition to the regular school gymnastic exercises. Changes observed in the physical characteristics of these children who received posture training are compared with those found among children in other rooms of the same grade of the school who received no special training, the groups being similar in nationality and age distribution. The analysis includes 1,708 children, of whom 961 received special training in posture and 747 received no special training. The ages of the children ranged from 5 to 18 years, most of them being between 7 and 15.

It was found that before any posture training was given 90 per cent of the children had poor posture, the proportion of poor posture among the girls being slightly larger than among the boys. At the

end of the school year 62 per cent of the children who received special training had improved in posture as compared with 10 per cent of those who received no training.

Improvement in scholarship and better deportment seemed to be associated with better body mechanics. The attendance records of the children also suggest that posture training improves their general health. There was less absence due to illness during the spring quarter than during the fall quarter among both groups of children, but the improvement in attendance was greater in the group receiving posture training. Good nutrition seems to be a prerequisite of good posture as it was among children who already had good nutrition that the greatest improvement in posture took place.

Preparation of popular child-hygiene bulletins.

Popular bulletins on child health issued during the year include a folder, Keeping the Well Baby Well, lesson material for mothers' classes on the care of the preschool child, and a revised and enlarged edition of Child Management. The lesson material consists of nine lessons with problems to be worked out by the mothers, each on some phase of child care, such as the child's health examination, teeth, posture, and food likes and dislikes. An additional leaflet gives a brief list of references on child health. Two other folders are in preparation: Why Sleep? and Care of the Preschool Child; and a new bulletin on child care is being written, which will be issued as a substitute for Publication No. 30, under the same title, Child Care.

CHILD WELFARE AND THE EMPLOYMENT OF MOTHERS

At the request of the Child Health Society of Philadelphia the bureau commenced, in January, 1928, a study of the relationship between child welfare and the employment of mothers in that city. The principal object of this inquiry is to ascertain, by obtaining comparable information for families of working and nonworking mothers, the effect of the mother's employment upon her efficiency as a mother, or, more concretely, upon the general welfare of the family and the health, schooling, and conduct of the children. In addition, it is hoped that the information obtained will throw light on the extent to which mothers of young children in a modern industrial community are employed outside the home, the trends and causes of such employment, and the relationship between mothers' employment and fathers' occupations, earnings, and contributions to the family income.

In a house-to-house canvass of 12,227 families having one or more children under 16 years of age it was found that 23 per cent of the mothers were employed, in most cases outside their own homes, at the time of the inquiry. The families canvassed lived in different parts of the city in 11 districts especially selected as typical of the industrial neighborhoods of the city as a whole. They constituted a fairly representative cross section of the city's wage-earning population as to race and nativity. The proportion of white mothers who were working at the time of inquiry was considerably less than of the colored—19 per cent as compared with 44 per cent. The proportion of white mothers with one or more children under 16 years of age found employed by the Children's Bureau in 1928 is approxi-

mately the same as the proportion among all married women and widows interviewed in a canvass of some 10,000 white women in industrial neighborhoods in Philadelphia made in 1918–19, an indication that there has been no decrease but rather in all probability a definite increase in employment among married women since the war period.

One-third of the mothers had had some kind of gainful employment during the year preceding the interview, and approximately half had been employed at some time since their marriage. Many had worked during the greater part of their married lives, some throughout the period, and fully one-fourth of the working mothers had been employed at least half their married years. While, as might be expected, relatively more mothers had gone to work whose husbands were dead or were for one reason or another away from home than mothers whose husbands were at home, the husbands in the great majority of families in which the women worked were at home with the family at the time of the survey. In 27 per cent of the families in which the mother was employed during the six months preceding the interview she was not the chief breadwinner, and in 18 per cent she was the only breadwinner.

For approximately 1,000 families in which the mother had been gainfully employed outside the home for at least five of the six months preceding the interview and for 1,000 families in which the mother had never been employed since marriage, much more detailed information regarding the economic status of the family, the mother's household activities and her work outside the home, if she was employed, and the health, education, conduct, and general welfare of the children has been obtained. Similar information will be obtained for a group of mothers who have been occupied gainfully in industrial employment in their own homes.

CHILD LABOR

Children to whom first regular employment certificates were issued.

The industrial division has continued during the past year to assemble reports on employment certificates issued to working children in order that current information may be available as to the trend in child labor as well as significant facts about the age and education of children going to work. Visits to a number of State and city officials resulted in an increase in the number of States and cities reporting to the bureau in 1927 as compared with 1926. Reports on the certificates issued during the calendar year 1927 were received for the District of Columbia, 16 States, and 69 cities in 18 other States, whereas for 1926 reports were received from the District of Columbia, 12 States, and 26 cities in 12 other States. It is estimated, on the basis of the 1920 census, that more than half the 14 and 15 year old children in the United States at work in occupations for which permits are usually required are employed in the States and cities from which the bureau is now receiving reports. It should be remembered, however, that there are occupations in which large numbers of children are employed—housework and farming, for example—which are not usually covered by the State child-labor laws, and also that the laws requiring work permits and

otherwise regulating the employment of children are not always well enforced in all States. No reports are received for employment in occupations not included by the State certificating laws nor, it seems unnecessary to state, for children employed in defiance of State laws.

The reports have been tabulated for all States and for cities with a population of 50,000 or over to show the number of certificates issued in each place, the ages and school grades completed by the boys and girls receiving these certificates, their distribution by occupational groups, and the evidence of age accepted by the issuing officers.

From this group of States and cities reports were received for 106,441 children 14 and 15 years of age and 47,067 children 16 and 17 years of age who obtained their first working certificates in 1927. In addition to this group 954 children in cities of less than 50,000 population were reported as receiving their first working certificates in 1927. Of the 154,462 certificates issued, 18,667 were issued to children in cities or towns where regular certificates are issued for vacation and after-school work and no separate record is kept of such certificates. Except for these all the permits reported were for full-time regular employment.

The number of first regular certificates issued to children 14 and 15 years of age (that is, certificates that release from full-time school attendance and authorize full-time employment throughout the year) decreased from 2 to 61 per cent in 1927 as compared with the previous year in 11 States, in 17 cities in other States, and in the District of Columbia. In 4 States (Alabama, Connecticut, Maine, and Oregon) and in 8 cities in other States (San Francisco, Calif.; Minneapolis and St. Paul, Minn.; St. Louis, Mo.; Omaha, Nebr.; Syracuse, N. Y.; Scranton, Pa.; and Milwaukee, Wis.) this decline in the number of first regular certificates issued in 1927 as compared with 1926 followed a decline in 1926 as compared with 1925. Increases in the number of certificates issued were reported for 1 State (Kansas) and for 5 cities. Detroit, Los Angeles, New York City, and Wilmington had increases varying from less than 1 per cent to 13 per cent. Lincoln issued 10 certificates in 1927 and 5 in 1926.

Information for a period of three years is available for 10 States and for 19 cities in 10 other States and the District of Columbia. In these States and cities the number of first regular employment certificates issued increased 5 per cent in 1926 as compared with 1925 and decreased 8 per cent in 1927 as compared with 1926. It is generally believed that unemployment during 1927 is largely responsible for the decreases, although in periods of unemployment children who would otherwise be kept in school are often compelled to seek employment and are sometimes able to obtain work when their parents can not do so.

TABLE 3.—*Number of children 14 and 15 years of age receiving regular employment certificates for the first time in 1926 and 1927 and per cent of increase or decrease, as compared with the previous year, in States and cities of 50,000 population and over reporting.*[1]

State and city	1926	Per cent of increase (+) or decrease (−) as compared with 1925 [2]	1927	Per cent of increase (+) or decrease (−) as compared with 1926 [2]
States reporting:				
Alabama	960	−4.5	700	−27.1
Birmingham	240	+34.1	185	−22.9
Mobile	89	+48.3	79	−11.2
Arkansas			190	
Connecticut	7,574	−.4	6,318	−16.6
Bridgeport	878	+11.8	581	−33.8
Hartford	645	−4.6	629	−2.5
New Britain	391	−18.2	246	−37.1
New Haven	1,057	+14.0	982	−7.1
Waterbury	571	−9.9	478	−16.3
District of Columbia	220	+64.2	186	−15.5
Indiana	1,103	+14.2	847	−23.2
Fort Wayne	58	+3.6	38	−34.5
Gary			4	
Indianapolis	346	+35.7	233	−32.7
South Bend	88	−10.2	84	−4.5
Iowa			765	
Davenport			92	
Des Moines			169	
Sioux City			62	
Kansas	121	+72.9	124	+2.5
Kansas City	75		72	−4.0
Topeka	23		16	
Wichita	8		19	
Kentucky	969	+9.0	[3] 780	−19.5
Covington	56	−26.3	47	−16.1
Louisville	638	+16.6	507	−20.5
Maine	[4] 256	−5.9	[4] 205	−19.9
Portland	[4] 21		[4] 21	
Maryland	4,449	+7.7	3,817	−14.2
Baltimore	4,229	+7.1	3,567	−15.7
Minnesota	404		310	−23.3
Minneapolis	171	−12.8	123	−28.1
St. Paul	160	−11.1	144	−10.0
New Jersey	[5] 18,429	+3.4	[5] 18,081	−1.9
Jersey City	[5] 1,638	+2.4	[5] 1,560	−4.8
Newark	[5] 2,494	+11.5	[5] 2,345	−6.0
Trenton	[5] 906	−1.5	[5] 867	−4.3
Oklahoma			848	
Oregon	377	−8.0	352	−6.6
Vermont	96	+5.5	49	−49.0
Washington			463	
Wisconsin	3,018		2,599	−13.9
Milwaukee	[6] 2,007	[6] −19.1	1,736	−13.5
Cities in States not reporting:				
California—				
Los Angeles	744		836	+12.4
Oakland			78	
Sacramento			40	
San Diego			147	
San Francisco	163	−39.0	156	−4.3
Colorado—Denver			209	
Delaware—Wilmington	252		286	+13.5
Georgia—Atlanta	132		52	−60.6
Illinois—				
Chicago	[6] 5,281	[6] +3.0	4,186	−20.7
East St. Louis			123	
Peoria			66	
Springfield			135	
Louisiana—New Orleans	2,563	+2.3	1,743	−32.0

[1] Population according to census of 1920. Figures from State or local official sources.
[2] Not shown where base is less than 50 nor where figures for previous year are not available.
[3] Excludes 5 reported too late for tabulation.
[4] Number of 15-year-old children receiving certificates; law does not permit the issuance of regular certificates to children under 15.
[5] Includes children to whom regular certificates were issued for work outside school hours, no certificates for such work being issued.
[6] Revised figures supplied by State.

TABLE 3.—*Number of children 14 and 15 years of age receiving regular employment certificates for the first time in 1926 and 1927 and per cent of increase or decrease, as compared with the previous year, in States and cities of 50,000 population and over reporting*—Continued

State and city	1926	Per cent of increase (+) or decrease (−) as compared with 1925	1927	Per cent of increase (+) or decrease (−) as compare e with 1926
Cities in States not reporting—Continued.				
Massachusetts—				
Lawrence	----------	----------	405	----------
Lowell	----------	----------	233	----------
Lynn	----------	----------	268	----------
Somerville	----------	----------	275	----------
Springfield	----------	----------	391	----------
Michigan—				
Detroit	[4] 635	+53.9	[4] 687	+8.2
Grand Rapids	[4] 267	----------	[4] 177	−33.7
Saginaw	----------	----------	[4] 137	----------
Missouri—				
Kansas City	----------	----------	178	----------
St. Joseph	----------	----------	114	----------
St. Louis	3,407	−3.4	2,048	−39.9
Nebraska—				
Lincoln	5	----------	10	----------
Omaha	136	−15.5	117	−14.0
New Hampshire—Manchester	----------	----------	[7] 244	----------
New York—				
Buffalo	[5] 2,654	----------	2,599	−2.1
New York	35,484	+8.1	35,717	+.7
Niagara Falls	252	+41.6	172	−31.7
Rochester	1,841	+.4	1,604	−12.9
Syracuse	427	−4.5	375	−12.2
Yonkers	525	+36.7	490	−6.7
Ohio—				
Cincinnati	----------	----------	[8] 14	----------
Springfield	----------	----------	[8] 11	----------
Toledo	----------	----------	[8] 15	----------
Pennsylvania—				
Erie	----------	----------	267	----------
Harrisburg	154	+1.3	121	−21.4
Philadelphia	11,194	+8.2	9,932	−11.3
Pittsburgh	[6] 1,677	[6] +3.1	1,381	−17.7
Scranton	845	−11.0	697	−17.5
Wilkes-Barre	----------	----------	924	----------
Rhode Island—Providence	[4] 1,633	----------	[4] 1,563	−4.3
Tennessee—				
Chattanooga	----------	----------	76	----------
Knoxville	----------	----------	161	----------
Nashville	----------	----------	250	----------
Utah—Salt Lake City	----------	----------	97	----------

[4] Number of 15-year-old children receiving certificates; law does not permit the issuance of regular certificates to children under 15.
[6] Revised figures supplied by State.
[7] Includes 97 regular certificates issued for "after school" work.
[5] Number reported for year ended November 30.
[8] Certificates issued to children under 16 adjudged incapable of profiting substantially by further instruction.

Five States and 22 cities in 8 other States, which either under the law or by administrative practice require minors 16 or 17 years of age, or both, to obtain employment certificates, supplied the bureau with reports for 1927. Most of these showed decreases in numbers of certificates issued in 1927 as compared with 1926, undoubtedly due to the decline in employment opportunities.

TABLE 4.—*Number of minors 16 and 17 years of age receiving regular employment certificates for the first time in 1926 and 1927 and per cent of increase or decrease in 1927 as compared with 1926, in States and cities of 50,000 population and over reporting*[1]

State and city	1926	1927	Per cent of increase (+) or decrease (−), as compared with 1926[2]
States reporting:			
Alabama	2,116	----------	----------
Arkansas	----------	77	----------
Oklahoma	----------	1,351	----------
Oregon	2,080	1,687	−18.9
Washington	----------	1,877	----------
Wisconsin	[3] 5,007	[3] 4,656	−7.0
Milwaukee	[3] [4] 2,014	[3] 2,009	−0.2
Cities in States not reporting:			
California—			
San Diego	----------	486	----------
San Francisco	----------	2,160	----------
Georgia—Atlanta	65	5	−92.3
Louisiana—New Orleans	477	[5] 384	−19.5
Michigan—			
Detroit	7,962	8,711	+9.4
Grand Rapids	917	688	−25.0
Saginaw	----------	689	----------
New York—			
Buffalo	[3] 3,094	[3] 1,475	−52.3
New York	[3] 12,666	[3] 12,226	−3.5
Niagara Falls	----------	[3] 274	----------
Rochester	[3] 1,247	[3] 960	−23.0
Syracuse	[3] 248	[3] 225	−9.3
Yonkers	[3] 409	[3] 323	−21.0
Ohio—			
Akron	----------	1,133	----------
Cincinnati	----------	2,955	----------
Columbus	789	991	+25.6
Dayton	700	638	−8.9
Springfield	----------	410	----------
Toledo	1,398	1,438	+2.9
Youngstown	843	779	−7.6
Tennessee—Nashville	----------	[3] 158	----------
Utah—Salt Lake City	----------	311	----------

[1] Population according to census of 1920. Figures from State or local official sources.
[2] Not shown when figures for 1926 were not available.
[3] Number of 16-year-old children receiving certificates; law does not require certificates for those over 16.
[4] Revised figures supplied by State.
[5] Certificates issued to girls only; certificates are not required for boys of these ages.

The age at which children under 16 leave school for work is influenced by the policies of school-attendance departments and officials issuing certificates and by family and community standards, but in the main the age and the educational standards of the child labor and school attendance laws determine the proportion of children receiving certificates at 14 instead of 15 years of age. Fifteen States, the District of Columbia, and 41 cities in 18 other States reported the number of certificates issued to children of 14 and of 15, separately. In these places 38 per cent of the certificates were issued to children 14 years old and 62 per cent to children 15 years old. In the States and the cities in States requiring, without provision for exceptions, the completion of the eighth grade before children of 14 may receive work permits, 24 per cent of the total receiving certificates were 14 years of age, and in those States having an eighth-grade requirement but permitting exemptions or alternatives 29 per cent were 14 years of age. Reports from the larger

group of States requiring less than completion of the eighth grade for children 14 years of age show that 43 per cent of the certificates were issued to 14-year-old children. Within this last group of States, as within the group having an eighth-grade standard, there are variations in the percentage of children certificated at 14. For example, 71 per cent in Baltimore, Md., 68 per cent in New Orleans, La., 65 per cent in St. Louis, Mo., 64 per cent in Newark, N. J., 28 per cent in Louisville, Ky., 25 per cent in Des Moines, Iowa, and 21 per cent in Springfield, Ill., of all the certificates issued were to children 14 years of age.

In all the States and cities from which reports showing sex of certificated children were received, except Washington and Louisiana,[6] certificates for each age group are issued to both boys and girls, and the boys constituted 56 per cent of the total number in the 14 and 15 year group and 57 per cent of the 16 and 17 year group. A larger number of boys than of girls in each age group received certificates in all places except Bridgeport, Wilmington, Peoria, Fort Wayne, South Bend, Trenton, Buffalo, Rochester, Yonkers, Harrisburg, and Wilkes-Barre, where more girls of 14 and 15 than boys were given work permits, and Yonkers and Springfield (Ohio), where more girls than boys of 16 and 17 were certificated. Even in these places the girls were not much more numerous than the boys. In Buffalo, Wilmington, and Springfield (Ohio) more certificates were issued for domestic and personal service, work in which girls usually predominate, than for any other occupation.

Reports of the number of colored children who obtained work permits, received from 5 States, the District of Columbia, and 22 cities showed that only 2 per cent of the children 14 and 15 years of age were colored. In the District of Columbia, where 29 per cent of the population of these ages is colored, 11 per cent of the certificates were issued to colored children. In the States of Alabama and Kentucky and the cities of St. Louis and Atlanta, which have large colored populations, certificates were issued to very few or no colored children. One explanation of this fact is found in the type of work available for the colored children. In some States in which the colored population is large colored children usually find employment in agriculture, for which certificates are seldom required under the law. In cities the negro girls, and to some extent the negro boys, go into domestic and personal service. Though certificates for such work are issued in many of the places reporting on the number of colored children receiving work permits, the check-up on children working as domestic servants is less thorough than on children at work in other kinds of establishments, so that even in communities in which certificates are issued for this work many children no doubt go into domestic service without procuring certificates. The relative proportions of white and colored among minors of 16 and 17 years of age receiving permits were practically the same as for children of 14 and 15 in places reporting on colored minors of these ages.

More than half (58 per cent) of the 14 and 15 year old children entering employment in 1927 for whom reports as to school grade

[6] In the State of Washington no regular employment certificates are issued to girls under 16; in New Orleans certificates are required in practice for girls but not for boys 16 or 17 years old.

completed were received had completed the eighth or a higher grade—compared with 56 per cent in 1926—while 25 per cent in 1927 as compared with 28 per cent in 1926 had completed only the sixth or a lower grade. The District of Columbia, Indiana, Kansas, and Minnesota, and Oakland and San Francisco, Calif., reported 90 to 100 per cent of the 14 and 15 year old children obtaining work permits as having an eighth-grade education. The proportion of the girls and of the boys who completed the eighth grade was nearly the same.

The percentages of 14 and 15 year old children who had completed at least the eighth grade before receiving first regular certificates in 1927 are shown in the following list, with the corresponding percentages for 1926:

	1926 per cent	1927 per cent
Alabama	25	27
Birmingham	42	40
Mobile	13	16
California:		
Los Angeles	72	69
Oakland	[7]	95
Sacramento	[7]	[8]
San Francisco	96	99
Colorado: Denver	[7]	58
Connecticut	58	57
Bridgeport	83	88
Hartford	64	61
New Britain	43	36
New Haven	56	55
Waterbury	48	49
Delaware: Wilmington	77	77
District of Columbia	94	97
Georgia: Atlanta	[7]	[8]
Illinois:		
Chicago	62	66
East St. Louis	[7]	56
Peoria	[7]	59
Springfield	[7]	65
Indiana	[9] 100	[9] 100
Fort Wayne	97	[8]
Gary	[7]	[8]
Indianapolis	100	100
South Bend	100	100
Iowa	[7]	68
Davenport	[7]	68
Des Moines	[7]	75
Sioux City	[7]	63
Kansas	[7]	92
Kansas City	[7]	86
Topeka	[7]	[8]
Wichita	[7]	[8]
Kentucky	--	36
Covington	--	[8]
Louisville	--	39
Louisiana: New Orleans	32	32
Maine	--	70
Portland	--	[8]
Maryland: Baltimore	30	35
Massachusetts:		
Lawrence	[7]	47
Lowell	[7]	47
Somerville	[7]	41
Michigan: Detroit	60	58
Minnesota	100	100
Minneapolis	100	100
St. Paul	100	100
Missouri:		
Kansas City [10]	[7]	75
St. Louis	[7]	49
Nebraska: Lincoln	--	[8]
New Jersey: Trenton	39	33
New York:		
Buffalo	59	62
New York	67	67
Niagara Falls	57	59
Rochester	58	62
Syracuse	55	57
Yonkers	61	64
Pennsylvania:		
Erie	[7]	46
Harrisburg	31	28
Philadelphia	31	31
Pittsburgh	40	40
Scranton	33	33
Wilkes-Barre	[7]	35
Tennessee:		
Chattanooga	[7]	21
Knoxville	[7]	[8]
Vermont	18	[8]
Wisconsin	[7]	82
Milwaukee	[7]	83

[7] No report for 1926.
[8] Not shown where base is less than 50.
[9] I. e., 1926—99.7; 1927—99.8.
[10] In this city the work of the elementary-school course is completed in seven school years.

The educational requirement of the child labor laws is probably the most influential factor in the educational attainment of children leaving school for work. Among the States reporting the grades completed by children going to work Minnesota requires completion of the eighth grade with no exceptions, and Indiana and Kansas, the eighth grade with occasional exceptions under administrative policy, for both 14 and 15 year old children. In Minnesota all children receiving work permits had completed the eighth grade, in Indiana two had received permits by court order on less than the eighth-grade standard, and in Kansas 8 per cent of the certificates had been issued on exceptions to the grade requirement, all in Kansas City. In Wilmington (Del.), the District of Columbia, and Wisconsin, where the laws permitted exceptions either by decision of local authorities or on the basis of 9 years of school attendance (Wisconsin), children who had completed the eighth grade constituted 77 per cent, 97 per cent, and 82 per cent, respectively, of the total number receiving certificates.

In a few places where the law sets an educational requirement lower than the eighth grade the proportion of children receiving certificates who had completed at least the eighth grade was high. Generally, however, the proportion of certificated children completing the elementary-school course is low in States without an eighth-grade requirement. In 4 States and in 22 cities in 10 other States having less than an eighth-grade requirement for both 14 and 15 year old children, only 43 per cent of the children receiving certificates had completed the eighth or a higher grade.

Certificates issued to children 14 and 15 years of age in Ohio have not been included in this discussion of the school grade completed, as in that State no full-time certificates are issued to any minors under 16 except those who are adjudged mentally "incapable of benefiting substantially by further education." A total of 40 such certificates were reported as issued in Cincinnati, Springfield, and Toledo, while the reports received from Youngstown and Columbus show no certificates of this kind issued.

The grade last attended instead of the grade last completed was reported for children of 14 and 15 by 1 State and 7 cities. Fifty-five per cent of all children to whom certificates were issued in these places had last attended the eighth or a higher grade—in Arkansas, 41 per cent; Newark, 40 per cent; Salt Lake City, where only 97 children received certificates, 56 per cent; Providence, 58 per cent; Jersey City, 64 per cent; San Diego, 73 per cent; Grand Rapids, 79 per cent; and Manchester (N. H.), 91 per cent.

The proportion of the minors of 16 and 17 years who had completed the eighth grade in the cities from which reports on grade completed were received was 70 per cent (a slightly higher percentage of girls than of boys). The accompanying list shows these percentages in 1926 and 1927 for each city except Atlanta, where only 5 certificates were issued to minors of these ages. Ohio requires, with certain exceptions, completion of the seventh grade before minors of these ages can leave school for work, and Utah requires, also with exceptions, school attendance of all children up to the age of 18 unless they are employed. The other States in the group reporting fix no educational requirement for 16 and 17 year old minors seeking work permits.

	1926 per cent	1927 per cent
California: San Francisco	(11)	87
Louisiana: New Orleans	(11)	31
New York:		
Buffalo	(11)	66
New York	63	65
Niagara Falls	(11)	57
Rochester	64	68
Yonkers	69	65
Ohio:		
Cincinnati	(11)	71
Columbus	92	91
Springfield	(11)	98
Toledo	(11)	75
Youngstown	67	65

In Arkansas 47 per cent, in Grand Rapids 87 per cent, and in Salt Lake City 87 per cent of the minors 16 and 17 years of age had last attended the eighth or a higher grade.

Information concerning the occupational groups in which children 14 and 15 years of age obtaining first regular certificates found employment in 1927 was received from 11 States, 33 cities in 17 other States, and the District of Columbia—a much larger number than reported this information for 1926. Forty-two per cent of these children entered manufacturing and mechanical occupations; the next largest occupational group (27 per cent of the total) were children entering mercantile establishments, and the remaining 31 per cent went into public messenger or errand and delivery work, domestic and personal service, office work, and miscellaneous work not classified.

The reports classifying by sex of the children the occupations for which certificates were issued to 14 and 15 year old children showed that relatively more girls than boys (45 per cent as compared with 34 per cent) went into manufacturing and mechanical occupations. In office work there was a relatively larger proportion of girls, and, as would be expected, messenger service employed very few girls and domestic and personal service very few boys.

The proportions in different occupational groups entered by these 14 and 15 year old children varied considerably with community opportunities for employment. For example, in Maine 91 per cent of the children certificated did manufacturing and mechanical work; in Jersey City, N. J., 66 per cent entered mercantile work; and in Kansas 61 per cent were engaged in public messenger and delivery service. Mercantile employment predominated in the District of Columbia and in 13 of the 33 cities in States from which complete reports were not received; and it absorbed 50 per cent or more of the children in 5 of these cities—San Diego, Omaha, Jersey City, Rochester, and Scranton. In the State of Kansas and in Chicago and Kansas City (Mo.) more children entered messenger and delivery work than any other occupation. In the State of Minnesota and in 4 cities (Sacramento, San Francisco, Buffalo, and Salt Lake City) the largest group entered domestic and personal service.

Manufacturing and mechanical industries employed the largest proportion of the 16 and 17 year old minors receiving certificates in the 2 States and in 9 of the 13 cities in 7 other States reporting this information. In the other 3 cities (Springfield and Youngstown, Ohio, and Salt Lake City, Utah) domestic and personal service predominated. The distribution among occupational groups was practically the same for minors of 16 and 17 as for those of 14 and 15

[11] No report.

years of age in each locality except that the largest proportion of the younger group were in mercantile work in San Diego, New Orleans, Niagara Falls, and Rochester, and in domestic and personal service in San Francisco and Buffalo, instead of in manufacturing and mechanical work as among the older group in these cities.

In order to enable children to work when school is not in session without encouraging their withdrawal from school many State laws provide for the issuance of special certificates for employment during school vacations and out of school hours, and in a number of other States such certificates are issued in practice. It is customary to require the same evidence of age for these temporary certificates as for the regular certificates, but to waive the educational requirement, as such a certificate does not release a child from further school attendance. The District of Columbia, 10 States, and 34 cities in 14 other States reported 37,670 first vacation and out-of-school-hours certificates issued in 1927 to children 14 and 15 years of age. The number of certificates of this kind exceeded the number of new regular certificates issued during the year in the District of Columbia, Indiana, Maine, Vermont, and Wisconsin, and in Lynn, Grand Rapids, Lincoln, and Chattanooga. How generally such certificates are issued depends of course upon the availability of short-time jobs for inexperienced young workers, but it depends also upon the extent to which local issuing officers encourage temporary vacation certificates for children qualified for regular work permits in the hope that they will return to school in the fall.

Half-time or cooperative certificates are issued in some places to boys and girls who are employed under school supervision half time as part of a vocational or trade course, or who are able to carry day-school courses in addition to half-time employment not related to their school work. Reports showed that such certificates were issued to 764 children 14 and 15 years of age in Atlanta, Peoria, Lincoln, Cincinnati, Columbus, Philadelphia, and Knoxville, and to 2,353 children 16 or 17 years of age in New York City and Toledo.

The nature of the evidence of age accepted in the issuance of certificates is of the greatest importance in preventing the authorization of the employment of children who are in fact below the legal minimum age. The type of evidence was reported for 47,846 first regular certificates issued to 14 and 15 year old children in 9 States, the District of Columbia, and 38 cities in 18 other States. Though birth registration has greatly improved in the last 15 years it is still not practical to require this evidence for all children. However, official birth certificates or baptismal records were the evidence on which 84 per cent of these certificates reporting as to type of evidence were issued. Such proof was received for between 90 and 100 per cent of the certificates issued in Connecticut, Maine, Vermont, and Wisconsin, and in Chicago, Baltimore, Lowell, Somerville, Manchester (N. H.), Jersey City, Newark, Buffalo, Yonkers, Harrisburg, Philadelphia, Scranton, and Providence. On the other hand, less than 10 per cent of the certificates were issued on birth certificates or baptismal records in Arkansas, Kansas (none), Los Angeles, Oakland (none), Sacramento, San Diego, San Francisco, Denver, Atlanta (none), St. Joseph, Lincoln, and Chattanooga.

In all places with small percentages of certificates issued on birth certificates or baptismal records, the predominating type of evidence

was the school record of age except in Arkansas and in Chattanooga, where a considerable number of certificates were issued on such evidence as Bible record, passport, insurance policy, or on a physician's certificate of age with or without school records or other corroborative evidence.

Work histories of minors attending continuation school.

During the past year work has been continued on the series of studies of employed minors attending continuation schools which were undertaken by the industrial division of the bureau to find out what industries and occupations are entered by boys and girls 14 to 18 years of age who are starting out on their first jobs, and the extent to which age, sex, and previous schooling affect their opportunities of obtaining and keeping desirable employment. The tabulation of the statistical information obtained in the course of this study for some 15,000 employed minors in Milwaukee, Wis.; Newark and Paterson, N. J.; and Rochester and Utica, N. Y., is now under way.

Laws affecting the employment of minors and their administration.

During the past year work has continued on the revision of the compilation of the texts of child-labor and compulsory school attendance laws published by the bureau in 1915. Mimeographed summaries of the laws affecting child labor passed in 1927 and 1928 have been issued. An analysis of legal provisions affecting children in agriculture and an analysis and tabular summary of State laws and municipal ordinances regulating the work of children in street trades have been prepared for publication.

Series of nontechnical child-labor bulletins.

Plans have been made for a series of bulletins presenting briefly the results of the bureau's inquiries as to various aspects of the child-labor problem. The first two bulletins of this series, relating to child labor in agriculture and in street trades, have been completed and are in press. These summarize the findings of the bureau's investigations with regard to the work of children in these occupations and also give the results of inquiries made by other agencies.

Other reports completed during the past year.

The report of a survey of children engaged in street occupations in eight cities and a report on industrial home work of children in seven selected communities in New Jersey were in press at the close of the year under review.[11 a] The latter is one of the studies of various aspects of child labor in New Jersey made as part of a series of studies of child welfare in that State. A second report in this series—a survey of the work of children before and after school in Newark and Paterson—is ready for publication.

DELINQUENCY AND CHILD WELFARE

Juvenile delinquency in Maine.

At the request of the Maine Department of Public Welfare a study is being made of the extent of juvenile deliquency in that State, the facilities for caring for juvenile delinquents, and the methods used

[11 a] Children in Street Work (United States Children's Bureau Publication No. 183, issued July 7, 1928) and Child Labor in New Jersey—Part 2, Children Engaged in Industrial Home Work (United States Children's Bureau Publication No. 185, issued Aug. 20, 1928).

in dealing with cases in representative counties. Since Maine has no juvenile-court system and practically no record material is available, facts are being collected about current cases through the cooperation of courts and other agencies coming in contact with juvenile delinquents. Forms have been distributed through the State department of public welfare to courts, trial justices, police, sheriffs, probation officers, and social workers, on which abstracts of cases coming to their attention during the six-month period beginning February 1, 1928, will be made. In addition to obtaining general information about all cases of delinquency it is planned to make intensive case studies of a small number of children, including some who have committed minor offenses and some who are in the State schools for delinquents.

Uniform reporting of juvenile-court statistics.[12]

The number of juvenile courts cooperating with the bureau in the plan for uniform reporting of juvenile-court statistics of delinquency, dependency, and neglect has increased during the year, so that the number of courts participating at the close of the fiscal year was about 100. Several State departments of public welfare or other State agencies are cooperating actively, either by taking the plan into consideration in making revisions of annual and monthly reports required of courts or by calling the plan to the attention of juvenile-court probation officers.

During the coming year an effort will be made to expand the reporting area further by correspondence, visits to courts that have not yet adopted the plan, attendance at conferences of judges and probation officers, and personal visits to courts experiencing difficulty in using the cards. Study will be made of certain types of procedure not easily shown by the cards, and the bulletin of instructions will be revised to include further explanation of items that experience has shown are often misunderstood.

Only a very brief summary of the material supplied by the 42 courts in 15 States that reported for the entire calendar year 1927 can be presented here. Cards or tables for cases of children discharged from probation or supervision were sent in by many of the courts but are not included in this report. Tables prepared by the local courts were received from three courts, but because of certain difficulties only those for Philadelphia are included in this report. The number of cases reported by the individual courts ranged from 14 to 9,838.

Table 5 shows the number of delinquency cases and of dependency and neglect cases reported by the 42 courts.

Delinquency cases were reported by each of the 42 courts, but 8 reported no cases of dependency and neglect. The total number of dependency and neglect cases (12,150) is distinctly smaller than the number of delinquency cases (26,241) reported by the 34 courts sending cards or tables for both types of cases. The relative proportions of dependency and neglect cases and of delinquency cases cared for by the different courts showed much variation. Eight courts reported more dependency and neglect than delinquency; in

[12] Juvenile Court Statistics; a tentative plan for uniform reporting of statistics of delinquency, dependency, and neglect. United States Children's Bureau Publication No. 159. Washington, 1926.

the other 26 courts dependency and neglect cases constituted the smaller part of the court work. The wide variation in the number of dependency and neglect cases is due in part to the extent to which local agencies other than the court were caring for dependent and neglected children. The practice in some courts of filing the complaint against the adult responsible for the dependency and neglect rather than the children is also a factor. In some localities only those cases of dependency and neglect requiring court action were brought as a rule to the attention of the court, and these usually by social agencies, whereas in other communities a large proportion of the dependent and neglected children were referred to the court directly by parents and relatives, and the court was the principal or only local agency caring for such children. The proportion of cases of dependency and neglect referred to the courts by parents or relatives in different localities varied from zero to 64 per cent of the total; whenever this proportion was high the number of dependency and neglect cases under care of the court was found to be large.

TABLE 5.—*Delinquency and dependency or neglect cases disposed of during 1927 by 42 courts, by court and sex of child*

Geographical units over which courts had jurisdiction	Cases disposed of during year								
	Total	Delinquency				Dependency or neglect			
		Total		Boys' cases	Girls' cases	Total		Boys' cases	Girls' cases
		Number	Per cent [1]			Number	Per cent [1]		
Total	40,537	28,387	70.0	24,244	4,143	12,150	30.0	[2] 4,332	[2] 4,132
California: San Francisco County (San Francisco)	1,637	950	58.0	873	77	687	42.0	344	343
Connecticut:									
Bridgeport	599	516	86.1	440	76	83	13.9	36	47
Hartford	772	618	80.1	539	79	154	19.9	83	71
Indiana:									
Clay County (Brazil)	29	25	-------	14	11	4	-------	1	3
Delaware County (Muncie)	65	65	100.0	47	18	-------	-------	-------	-------
Jennings County (North Vernon)	16	4	-------	4	-------	12	-------	7	5
Lake County (Gary)	875	527	60.2	343	184	348	39.8	175	173
Marion County (Indianapolis)	1,183	892	75.4	589	303	291	24.6	146	145
Monroe County (Bloomington)	15	15	-------	10	5	-------	-------	-------	-------
Vermilion County (Clinton)	84	84	100.0	54	30	-------	-------	-------	-------
Wayne County (Richmond)	44	24	-------	15	9	20	-------	14	6
Wells County (Bluffton)	41	41	-------	23	18	-------	-------	-------	-------
White County (Monticello)	14	3	-------	3	-------	11	-------	5	6
Massachusetts: Middlesex County (Cambridge)	27	27	-------	24	3	-------	-------	-------	-------
Michigan: Kent County (Grand Rapids)	582	374	64.3	374	-------	208	35.7	100	108
Minnesota:									
Hennepin County (Minneapolis)	1,308	966	73.9	776	190	342	26.1	170	172
Ramsey County (St. Paul)	453	342	75.5	270	72	111	24.5	52	59
New Jersey:									
Hudson County (Jersey City)	1,685	1,685	100.0	1,482	203	-------	-------	-------	-------
Mercer County (Trenton)	215	215	100.0	197	18	-------	-------	-------	-------
New York:									
Buffalo	931	836	89.8	785	51	95	10.2	49	46
Clinton County (Plattsburg)	102	23	22.5	18	5	79	77.5	40	39
Columbia County (Hudson)	219	98	44.7	84	14	121	55.3	56	65
Delaware County (Stamford)	14	14	-------	14	-------	-------	-------	-------	-------
Dutchess County (Poughkeepsie)	494	223	45.1	183	40	271	54.9	123	148
Erie County (Buffalo)	231	177	76.6	159	18	54	23.4	28	26
Franklin County (Malone)	58	34	58.6	25	9	24	41.4	16	8

[1] Per cent not shown where base is less than 50.
[2] Exclusive of Philadelphia.

TABLE 5.—*Delinquency and dependency or neglect cases disposed of during 1927 by 42 courts, by court and sex of child*—Continued

Geographical units over which courts had jurisdiction	Cases disposed of during year								
	Total	Delinquency				Dependency or neglect			
		Total		Boys' cases	Girls' cases	Total		Boys' cases	Girls' cases
		Number	Per cent			Number	Per cent		
New York—Continued.									
New York City	9,345	6,102	65.3	5,262	840	3,243	34.7	1,743	1,500
Orleans County (Albion)	24	9	-------	8	1	15	-------	7	8
Westchester County (White Plains)	1,406	1,104	78.5	950	154	302	21.5	151	151
North Carolina:									
Buncombe County (Asheville)	304	144	47.4	122	22	160	52.6	72	88
Winston-Salem	319	295	92.5	239	56	24	7.5	9	15
Ohio:									
Franklin County (Columbus)	1,145	883	77.1	674	209	262	22.9	146	116
Hamilton County (Cincinnati)	1,586	1,332	84.0	1,332	(3)	254	16.0	120	134
Mahoning County (Youngstown)	1,907	1,684	88.3	1,391	293	223	11.7	105	118
Pennsylvania:									
Berks County (Reading)	61	48	78.7	39	9	13	21.3	4	9
Lycoming County (Williamsport)	27	10	-------	6	4	17	-------	7	10
Montgomery County (Norristown)	84	53	63.1	40	13	31	36.9	18	13
Philadelphia	9,838	6,152	62.5	5,396	756	3,686	37.5	(4)	(4)
Tennessee: Memphis	1,505	852	56.6	672	180	653	43.4	328	325
Virginia: Norfolk	914	728	79.6	615	113	186	20.4	90	96
Washington: Pierce County (Tacoma)	219	126	57.5	98	28	93	42.5	53	40
Wisconsin: Dane County (Madison)	160	87	54.4	55	32	73	45.6	34	39

[3] Tables received for about 700 girls' cases not included.
[4] Sex not reported.

The proportion of boys to girls was about equal in dependency cases, but in delinquency cases the number of boys (24,244) reported was nearly six times the number of girls (4,143). There was, however, much variation in the proportion of delinquent girls in different localities.

As a number of children came before the courts more than once the 28,387 delinquency cases represented 25,456 children, and the 12,150 dependency and neglect cases represented 11,789 children. Of the delinquent children 84 per cent were white and 16 per cent colored (15 per cent were negroes). As would be expected the proportion of delinquent children who were colored was larger in the southern courts. In Winston-Salem, N. C., 73 per cent and in Norfolk, Va., 52 per cent of the delinquent children were colored. In the northern and midwestern courts the percentage of white children varied from 71 per cent to 100 per cent. Of the dependent or neglected children brought to the 34 courts reporting dependency or neglect cases, in the South as well as in the North, white children constituted a percentage slightly in excess of the corresponding percentage among delinquent children (87 per cent as compared with 84 per cent).

Of the 42 courts reporting to the bureau 21 had jurisdiction over children up to 16 years of age;[13] 1 (Kent County, Mich.) had juris-

[13] Bridgeport and Hartford, Conn.; Hudson and Mercer Counties, N. J. (girls up to 17 may be committed to the State home for girls by the juvenile court); Buffalo, New York City, and Clinton, Columbia, Delaware, Dutchess, Erie, Franklin, Orleans, and Westchester Counties, N. Y.; Buncombe County and Winston-Salem, N. C.; Berks, Lycoming, and Montgomery Counties, and Philadelphia, Pa.; and Memphis, Tenn.

diction up to 17 years; 7 had jurisdiction up to 18 years;[14] and the jurisdiction of 1 (San Francisco, Calif.) extended to 21 years. Of the remaining 12 courts, 10 had jurisdiction over delinquent, dependent, and neglected boys up to 16, delinquent girls up to 18, and dependent and neglected girls up to 17;[15] 1 (Dane County, Wis.) had jurisdiction over delinquent boys up to 17, delinquent girls up to 18, and dependent and neglected children up to 16; and 1 (Middlesex County, Mass.) had jurisdiction over delinquent children between 7 and 17 years and neglected children under 16 years of age.

The following list, which gives the ages of the children dealt with by these courts on charges of delinquency, shows that most of the children who came before these courts were from 12 to 16 years of age. The number above 16, however, would have been larger had it not been for the limitation of the jurisdiction of many courts to children under that age.

	Boys	Girls
Under 10	1,552	152
10, under 12	3,117	261
12, under 14	5,575	773
14, under 16	7,929	1,848
16 and over[16]	2,200	679
Age not reported	1,166	204

In about one-half of both the delinquency and the dependency and neglect cases the children were not detained but were allowed to remain in their own homes pending hearing, or their cases were disposed of on the day the complaint was made. Boarding homes were used by more than half the 42 courts in delinquency cases and by most of the courts reporting cases of dependency and neglect, but the number of cases so cared for was small. In about one-third of the delinquency cases and in approximately the same proportion of cases of dependency and neglect the child was cared for in a detention home or other institution. A relatively small proportion of children were cared for in jails or police stations, these being largely older children in courts whose jurisdiction included those over 16 years of age.

Though an attempt is being made to secure uniformity in the use of terms the charges on which children were dealt with by the courts as delinquents give a very incomplete picture of their behavior problems. A child may have committed several offenses at or about the same time but be referred to court on only one of them. The specific offense with which he is charged may be much less serious than offenses discovered in the course of the social investigation. When the case is investigated before the filing of a petition instead of afterwards, the formal charge is usually more accurate, but even in such cases the offense stated in the complaint may reflect the desire of the court to protect the child. For instance, in some courts a girl is charged with incorrigibility instead of a sex offense, or a boy with trespassing and taking the property of another instead of "breaking and entering" or "burglary."

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[14] Hennepin and Ramsey Counties, Minn.; Franklin, Hamilton, and Mahoning Counties, Ohio; Norfolk, Va.; and Pierce County, Wash.

[15] Clay, Delaware, Jennings, Lake, Marion, Monroe, Vermilion, Wayne, Wells, and White Counties, Ind.

[16] 41 courts (exclusive of Philadelphia) reported 59 of the boys and 28 of the girls as "18 years and over."

According to the recorded offenses the boys and girls present quite different delinquency problems. The distribution of charges in 24,244 boys' and 4,143 girls' cases was as follows:

	Per cent in boys' cases	Per cent in girls' cases
Stealing or attempted stealing	41	13
Acts of carelessness or mischief	27	7
Truancy or running way	15	29
Ungovernable or beyond parental control	7	27
Sex offense	2	19
Injury or attempted injury to person	3	3
Liquor or drug violation	1	1
Other offenses or nature of offense not reported	3	2

More than two-thirds of the boys were charged with stealing or with acts of carelessness or mischief. Apparently some courts class petty stealing as "mischief" rather than "stealing." With the girls "truancy," "running away," "ungovernable or beyond parental control," and "sex offenses" are the most frequent charges, three-fourths of them having been charged with these offenses.

The great variation in the types of offenses with which children were charged in the different courts would indicate that the attitude and practices of the court as well as differing social conditions are the explanation of such variation. For example, the percentage of sex offenses among the girls' cases varied from 2 to 62 in the different courts. Among the boys stealing varied from 22 to 82 per cent of the cases.

The practice of the court in regard to handling cases unofficially (i. e., informal adjustments by the judge, referee, or probation officer, so that the cases are not placed on the court calendar by the filing of a petition or other legal paper for adjudication by the judge or referee) varied in different localities. Information is being recorded for both official and unofficial cases, the same cards being used for both, with the exception that separate lists of dispositions are used for the two types of cases. Twenty-three of the forty-two courts reported the practice of disposing of some delinquency cases unofficially. More than one-fourth of the delinquency cases (7,560) were reported to be dealt with in this way. In five courts, two of which reported a large number of cases, from 71 to 97 per cent of the delinquency cases were handled unofficially.

Analysis of 20,827 delinquency cases that had been handled officially by the courts shows that the dispositions of a large majority (88 per cent) were: (1) Dismissed or continued indefinitely (34 per cent), (2) placed on probation (39 per cent), or (3) committed to institutions for delinquents (15 per cent). A number of different but related methods of treatment of delinquent children are included under each of these three terms. For example, the entry "case dismissed" was made for cases closed without further action, cases referred to other courts for commitment to institutions for the feeble-minded, and cases dismissed because of lack of jurisdiction in the juvenile court. Cases were considered as "continued indefinitely" when no further action was taken nor supervision given the children but jurisdiction was maintained, so that if a like situation arose later the case might be brought into court again without the filing of a petition. Cases of children placed on probation to parents or com-

mitted to institutions with commitment suspended when no further action was contemplated were included in this classification. Orders for restitution, fines, and payment of costs were resorted to in only 6 per cent of the 20,827 official delinquency cases.

Of the 7,560 unofficial delinquency cases more than half (58 per cent) were reported closed after adjustment, one-seventh (14 per cent) were placed unofficially under the supervision of a probation officer, and of the remaining cases a large proportion were apparently dropped without action of any sort.

In official delinquency cases the offenses most often disposed of by dismissal or indefinite continuance were injury or attempted injury to person, acts of carelessness or mischief, truancy in the girls' cases, and what among the boys was classified as "other miscellaneous charges." [16a] Probation was used more often than any other type of disposition in the following types of cases: Stealing (47 per cent of the 7,121 cases), ungovernable or beyond parental control (43 per cent of the 1,924 cases), sex offense in boys' cases (51 per cent of the 355 cases), violating liquor or drug law in boys' cases (47 per cent of the 99 cases), and running away in girls' cases (43 per cent of the 417 cases). Commitment to an institution was used more frequently for sex offenses of girls than for any other offense among either boys or girls. The contrast in treatment of boys and of girls for this offense is striking. The reports show that in 14 per cent of the 355 cases of boys charged with sex offenses the boy was committed to an institution for delinquent children and in 51 per cent he was placed on probation, whereas in 37 per cent of the 599 cases of girls who were sex delinquents the girl was committed to an institution for delinquent children and in 35 per cent she was placed on probation. On the other hand, when truancy was the charge, in only 5 per cent of the girls' cases as compared with 18 per cent of the boys' cases were the children sent to institutions for delinquent children. Commitment to an institution for delinquent children was reported in about equal proportions for the boys (25 per cent of the 1,201 cases) and the girls (27 per cent of the 723 cases) described as ungovernable or beyond parental control. Similarly, commitment to such institutions was used in 22 per cent of the boys' cases and 21 per cent of the girls' cases in which the child was charged with running away from home. Fines or costs were ordered chiefly in the cases of boys charged with acts of carelessness or mischief—15 per cent of the 3,533 cases.

FAMILY COURTS

Public interest in the family court, or court of domestic relations (terms often used synonymously), is increasing, but proposals for legislation establishing new courts are often made without an adequate basis of information concerning the work of these first experimental courts or existing local court systems and the legal framework and social setting in which the new courts must find their place. The report of the study which the Children's Bureau has been making of courts especially organized to deal with family problems

[16a] This discussion does not include the Philadelphia court, as figures showing disposition by charges are not available for Philadelphia.

is nearing completion. Part 1 of the report presents a general review of the legal aspects of the treatment of domestic-relations problems and of attempts to provide methods of organization and administration especially adapted to modern conditions, together with suggestions as to the general principles that should govern the establishment of new courts or the reorganization of existing courts. This section of the report was submitted to a number of the leading authorities on this subject, to whom the bureau is indebted for helpful criticism.

The general conclusions reached as a result of the study, in summary form, are as follows:

1. In considering the attitude of the law to domestic relations two factors must be kept constantly in mind: First, that law is a process of social engineering, that the organization of the society with which it deals is changing, and that it must discover and perfect new tools to fulfill its functions; second, that it is necessary to ascertain and deal with the facts, that sentimentalism is as dangerous as ignorance, and that changes in legal processes should be conditioned upon practicability.

2. Great need exists for the extension as rapidly as possible of the judicial technique developed by juvenile courts to matters bearing upon family relations coming within the scope of the report. This technique includes informal adjustment and reference to appropriate agencies of cases not requiring official court action, thorough social investigation, physical and psychiatric examinations when necessary, informal hearings conducted with a minimum of publicity, and constructive supervision of probationers.

3. Because of variation in local institutions and conditions a nation-wide formula for the adjustment of family problems coming before the courts is impossible. Wide differences exist not only in constitutional provisions and court systems but also in the degree of public interest in a social approach to legal problems involving child welfare and family life. Nevertheless, efforts of all interested groups should be directed toward the establishment and maintenance of tribunals that will have broad powers to deal with family problems.

4. The proper treatment of children's cases must be assured. The juvenile court requires continuing study, constructive criticism, and constant support by the public, whether it continues to exist as a separate court or becomes part of a court of broader jurisdiction. In general, where juvenile courts have been established they should be brought to a high standard of efficiency before an attempt is made to extend their jurisdiction further. It may be, however, that in a given situation it would be easier to obtain adequate administrative machinery for the juvenile court if it were absorbed in a new court with broad jurisdiction, but the plan for administration should always be worked out carefully in advance.

5. The new judicial technique seems particularly applicable to nonsupport and desertion, the support of children born out of wedlock, and certain offenses against children, especially contributing to dependency and delinquency. Some of these methods, especially investigation, should be extended also to cases of adoption, guardianship of the person of children, and commitment of mentally defective children. Divorce cases present special problems. Only a minority of divorce cases (somewhat more than one-third) involve children. The problem of ascertaining the real causes of marital difficulties and of adjusting them without resort to divorce procedure is very difficult, and at least under present conditions it is not one which courts are equipped or can reasonably be expected to become equipped to solve. Alimony and custody of children are subject to the continuing jurisdiction of the court, and the new technique of investigation and supervision is required in order to safeguard the interests involved. The possibility of vesting in the juvenile or family court jurisdiction as to divorce cases involving children, or as to custody of children and alimony for the support of children requires careful consideration.

6. Depending upon local conditions, social treatment of the cases mentioned above may be developed in one unified court, having also juvenile jurisdiction, in one court with separate branches for juvenile and domestic-relations work, or in separate juvenile and domestic-relations courts. Unified jurisdiction is desirable when it can be obtained without the sacrifice of more important ends.

7. Whenever jurisdiction over domestic-relations cases can be centered in one court by some working agreement on the part of the several judges such action appears to be more desirable than appeal to a legislative body, provided that an adequate social-service staff can be maintained. This plan lacks the dramatic quality of the establishment of a new court, but it has the advantage of ease of accomplishment and flexibility.

8. Attempts to obtain the passage of legislation providing for the establishment of family courts or courts of domestic relations invariably should be preceded by careful study of the constitutional and statutory provisions of the State regarding courts and court systems, study of existing methods of dealing with juvenile cases and adult cases involving family problems in the locality which the proposed court would serve, and education of the public as to the need for socialized treatment of juvenile and family problems, its cost and its value.

9. Wherever jurisdiction is vested in a juvenile court, a family court, or a court of domestic relations, if it is to develop into an efficient instrument of social justice it must be free from political influence and must have am-

ple financial support and a staff of men and women fitted by nature, education, and experience to carry on the delicate tasks intrusted to them. The services of the social case worker, the physician, the psychologist, and the psychiatrist, all are necessary to its proper development.

10. The work of legal-aid bureaus and other social agencies dealing with domestic-relations problems should be strengthened and extended. A valuable contribution could be made toward the understanding and solution of marital difficulties and allied problems if funds were made available for the development in selected communities of domestic-relations clinics, staffed by psychiatrists, psychologists, and social investigators. These clinics should be available to any person desiring help in adjusting troubles growing out of the marital relation.

11. Finally, there emerge from this study the significant facts of overlapping jurisdictions, inadequacy of treatment, and other failures of law to meet family problems. Public responsibility for the correction of these conditions must be fulfilled though the particular type of organization selected for dealing with them may vary.

DEPENDENT CHILDREN

Public aid to mothers with dependent children.

With mothers' aid legislation on the statute books of 44 States, interest in the administration of such laws has so increased that a specialist in this work was added to the staff of the social-service division of the bureau last autumn in order that requests, especially those for local consultation on administration problems, might be met. The preparation of a handbook on the administration of mothers' aid has been undertaken by the bureau at the request of the National Committee on Public Aid to Mothers of Dependent Children in Their Own Homes. The standards, policies, and procedures that have been worked out during the past 15 years will be presented in the handbook in a form suitable for reference by busy administrators.

To meet the demand for information as to the extent to which mothers' aid laws are actually applied at the present time the bulletin on public aid to mothers with dependent children issued in 1926 was brought up to date, and some additional information was incorporated. It is estimated that on any one date approximately 200,000 children are now receiving this form of public aid in their own homes. No estimate can be made of total expenditure, but information available for 20 States indicates an annual expenditure in these States of about $18,000,000 for the support of children in their own homes.

A report of a study of administrative practices with reference to health, housing, education, and recreation of representative agencies that were administering mothers' aid in 10 different localities was in press at the end of the fiscal year.[17] Descriptions of the community

[17] Administration of Mothers' Aid in Ten Localities, with Special Reference to Health, Housing, Education, and Recreation, by Mary F. Bogue. U. S. Children's Bureau Publication No. 184. Issued Aug. 20, 1928.

resources for providing health care, education, and recreation that were available in each of the localities and information as to the extent to which these were utilized by the agencies also are included. In general, this report may be said to show the extent to which these agencies were providing, for the families under their care, the services that make of mothers' aid a general-welfare measure rather than a relief measure only.

Welfare of prisoners' families in Kentucky.

A report has recently been issued of a study of the influence of the imprisonment of the fathers upon the welfare of 210 Kentucky families with dependent children. The men whose families were included in the investigation had been imprisoned in the State penitentiary or the reformatory for periods ranging from nine months to nine years. Although the case histories showed that the majority of the mothers and older children did everything in their power to earn a livelihood for the family, only 33 of the 210 families were known to be self-supporting at the time of the study. The compensation paid the prisoners for the labor they performed in the State institutions had been fixed by the State board of charities and corrections at 10 cents per day. The possible contribution by the men through their own labor to the support of their families was therefore so small that it had little effect upon the condition of the family, even in the cases where assignments were made regularly by the fathers. The burden of assisting in the support of the families fell usually upon relatives, in many cases with a lowering of the standard of living for both families. Many of the families were showing the results of hardships endured during the father's absence in lowered physical resistance, interruption of the children's schooling, and separation of families. (A 1926 law applicable only to prisoners employed on road work makes possible for such prisoners compensation greater than that specified above.)

During the time that the field work for this study was in progress (March–July, 1926) Kentucky had made no public provision for aid to dependent children in their own homes nor for organized county agencies for case work with families in need, and private social agencies served only a few of the more populous counties. The only agency providing assistance to any number of the families was the Mutual Welfare League, maintained by the prisoners in the reformatory. Within the last year a law has been enacted creating a State children's bureau and county children's bureaus, and authorizing the counties to provide aid for mothers with dependent children.

Children of illegitimate birth.

A report is in press based on 253 selected case histories of children of illegitimate birth whose custody had been retained by relatives. Thirty-five histories are given in detail as illustrative of the methods of care by which the mothers or other relatives were enabled to keep the children with them. A brief analysis is included of the general findings of the study and the policies of the agencies from which the histories were obtained.

A chart containing an analysis and tabular summary of State laws relating to illegitimacy in the United States in effect January

1, 1928, and the texts of selected laws of a number of States which reflect the recent tendencies in legislation being enacted for this group of dependent children was prepared at the request of the League of Nations for the meeting of its Advisory Commission on the Welfare of Children and Young Persons, in March, 1928, and will be available for general distribution shortly.

STATE AND COUNTY CHILD-WELFARE AGENCIES

Methods of administration of State child-welfare activities.

Since 1917 new legislation defining the responsibilities and activities of State departments concerned with child welfare and establishing new administrative machinery has been passed in a number of States. In order to make the history of the development and experience of these States available for comparison field work has been begun in connection with a study of these State departments, boards, or commissions, as they are variously called. The practice in 10 States that illustrate different types of administration will be studied as fully as possible.

Plans are in progress for a special study of the achievements and methods of work of the children's bureau of the Minnesota State Board of Control, which was established in 1918 and has been a pioneer in the development of coordinated State and county programs. The report will include a general analysis of the functions and activities of the bureau and of the county child-welfare boards that serve as its local representatives throughout the State of Minnesota and an evaluation of the type of work done and the extent to which the needs of local communities have been met.

County studies in Washington and Wisconsin.

A preliminary report of the study of child-welfare conditions and resources in six counties in the State of Washington has been prepared and presented to the Washington State Conference of Social Work, at whose request the study was made. The object of this study was to find out the social resources of the different localities, the number of children in the communities in whose behalf special activities were being carried on, and the extent to which legislation and State and local resources succeeded in providing adequately for all children in need of assistance.

Records were obtained for 7,419 children under 18 years of age in the six counties who had received assistance from public or private agencies during the year. A total of 6,576 had been aided in their own homes by overseers of the poor, mothers' aid boards, or private family-welfare agencies. A large number of the children (1,992) were in families receiving mothers' assistance, but comparatively small grants were permitted by law. Eight hundred and forty-three children had been cared for away from their families, 349 in family homes under agency supervision and 494 in institutions for dependents. Legislation that will safeguard children needing care away from their own families is greatly needed in Washington. At the time of the study parental guardianship could be transferred without court action. The State law did not safeguard adoptions by requiring a social investigation in all such cases before action by the court, and no State regulation of boarding homes existed.

In all the counties visited juvenile cases were heard either in juvenile branches or in special sessions of the superior court. A total of 2,406 cases were disposed of during the year—1,874 cases of delinquency and 532 cases of dependency or neglect. Institutional care for delinquents was used more extensively than probation; 281 of the children whose cases were heard officially during the year were committed to institutions, and only 115 were placed on probation.

One very evident weakness of the welfare program of the counties was the limited extent to which local authorities or agencies had attempted to carry out the laws providing for court action in cases of nonsupport and desertion, and proceedings to establish paternity.

Washington has no State department of public welfare, such as has been created in many States, with definite responsibility for studying the welfare conditions and needs of the State, developing local resources for caring for children, and aiding in the maintenance of adequate standards by the agencies caring for children. The evidence of the need for such a State department was encountered repeatedly in the counties studied. Although the standards of most of the private agencies and institutions giving care to children varied from acceptable to excellent a few of them fell far below the minimum standards that should be required by the State for the protection of these dependent children. The activities of public agencies, such as the administration of mothers' aid, poor relief, and the probation service of the juvenile court, differed greatly in quality in the counties. The cooperation of a State department in formulating policies, setting standards, and obtaining uniform reports should be of assistance to county and municipal authorities.

During the past year a plan was made and schedules were prepared for a study in Wisconsin that would provide information as to actual conditions affecting the welfare of children in several counties. This material was desired by the children's code committee of the Wisconsin Conference of Social Work for the development of a program. The Children's Bureau undertook to make the field study in four counties, local committees undertaking this work in six additional counties. Individual schedules were obtained of all children under the care of agencies and institutions, and information was gathered on the health and recreational resources of the communities and on the organization and activities of all available social agencies and institutions. The report will be prepared and published by the children's code committee of the Wisconsin Conference of Social Work.

RECREATION

Field work has been completed on a study of the recreation of children living on farms or in villages in West Virginia. This study was undertaken at the request of the extension service of the West Virginia State College of Agriculture. Through interviews with the children in the schools of 12 rural districts in five counties schedules were secured for 1,932 children between 10 and 18 years of age. Information was thus obtained in regard to the amount of leisure time of the children and the use which was made of it. Special emphasis was placed upon the character of the social contacts of the children

and the extent to which the children participated in club activities and other organized recreation.

In addition to obtaining information as to the social life and recreation of individual children studies were made of community facilities and their use, the activities of agencies contributing to the social life of the children, and the character of the play leadership in the communities.

During the past year the bureau has cooperated with the agricultural extension service of the State university in six States in the development of recreation programs for club groups. Courses for recreation leaders in games, folk dancing, pageantry, and story-telling and in the planning of recreation programs were given to 14 groups of 4–H Club members and rural women attending camps or short courses organized by the extension service. A similar course was given under the auspices of the Young Women's Christian Association in one city.

STATE CHILD-WELFARE COMMISSIONS

Official child-welfare commissions have been active during the past year in only three States—Georgia, Kentucky, and South Dakota. The Georgia commission sponsored several bills that were considered by the session of the legislature meeting during the summer of 1927. These measures, only one of which became law, were included in last year's annual report. Since the adjournment of the legislature the commission has been inactive. The Kentucky Child Welfare Commission sponsored a bill for its own abolition and the creation in its place of a State children's bureau. This bill, which also authorized the establishment of county children's bureaus and public aid to mothers of dependent children, became a law. The South Dakota Child Welfare Commission cooperated in the second annual conference of county welfare boards, which was held in conjunction with the State conference of social work. A second survey of mothers' pensions in the State is under way, and assistance is reported by the secretary in prosecutions of offenders against young girls. Members of the California Commission for the Study of Problem Children, authorized by a law passed in 1927, were appointed by the governor in February, 1928. The New Jersey Juvenile and Probation Study Commission, with the cooperation of the National Probation Association, made a study of probation and juvenile-court work throughout the State and published its findings and recommendations in pamphlet form. Bills sponsored by the commission relating to juvenile and domestic-relations courts and probation were introduced but not passed.

Unofficial committees interested in child-welfare legislation have been at work in several States. After the discontinuance of the Pennsylvania Children's Commission in 1927 the executive committee of the child-welfare committee of the Pennsylvania Public Charities Association resolved to undertake a general study of Pennsylvania statutes relating to children and the proposal of such revisions as should seem desirable in these statutes. The Illinois State Conference of Social Work and State department of public welfare have appointed a committee to review the recommendations made in 1920

by a children's committee appointed by the department of public welfare and to draw up a program for future action. Reference has already been made to the assistance given by the Children's Bureau to the Washington State Conference of Social Work and the children's code committee of the Wisconsin Conference of Social Work in the studies of child-welfare needs and resources in selected counties of these two States.

CHILD-WELFARE LEGISLATION, 1928

During 1928 regular legislative sessions were held in 9 States—Kentucky, Louisiana, Massachusetts, Mississippi, New Jersey, New York, Rhode Island, South Carolina, and Virginia—and in Porto Rico and Hawaii. In addition, Congress legislated for the District of Columbia. Special sessions were held in a few States, including Illinois, Nevada, North Dakota, and Wisconsin, but so far as the bureau has been able to obtain information, no new child-welfare legislation was enacted in these special sessions.[18] Legislative material has been received by the Children's Bureau from the States having regular sessions and from Porto Rico.

Child labor and compulsory school attendance.

Measures relating to legal standards affecting the employment of children, either directly or through requiring attendance at school, were enacted by Congress for the District of Columbia and by the States of Kentucky, New Jersey, New York, Rhode Island, South Carolina, and Virginia. Porto Rico established a research division in the department of education.

The new District of Columbia child labor law constitutes a great advance over the former law, particularly in regard to the enforcement and administrative provisions and to the regulation of the work of children in street trades and in dangerous or injurious occupations. It removes the poverty exemption for children 12 years of age or over and establishes a minimum age of 14 in all gainful occupations except housework or agricultural work performed outside school hours for the child's parent or guardian, with the proviso that children 12 years of age and over may sell newspapers and children 10 years of age and over may distribute newspapers on regular routes. It also fixes an 8-hour day and 48-hour week and a 6-day week for children between the ages of 14 and 18 years. Work between 7 p. m. and 7 a. m. is prohibited for boys under 16 and for girls under 18 years of age, and work between 10 p. m. and 6 a. m. is prohibited for boys between 16 and 18. Specified dangerous or injurious occupations are prohibited for minors under 16 and under 18 years of age, and a general clause prohibits the employment of any minor at employment dangerous or prejudicial to his life, health, safety, or welfare. At least two inspectors must be appointed by the board of education to enforce the law.

The workmen's compensation law passed by Congress for the District of Columbia covers all employees and would therefore apply to minor as well as adult workers.

[18] In Illinois a law relating to mothers' aid which had been passed in 1927 was reenacted in order to indicate clearly which of two laws passed in that year is in effect.

In Kentucky a bill was passed strengthening the enforcement provisions of the compulsory school attendance law and setting a maximum fine of $15 for the parent's failure to send his child to school.

In New Jersey the educational requirement for employment certificates for children between 14 and 16 years of age was raised from completion of the fifth grade in certain subjects to completion of the sixth grade in those subjects or completion of a program in a prevocational or vocational school approved by the commissioner of education equivalent to one year beyond the fifth grade. This provision becomes effective September 1, 1929.

In New York the compulsory school attendance and employment certificate laws have been rewritten. The former law is greatly clarified and simplified, the application of the law is broadened, and the administrative provisions are improved. A physical examination is required when the child goes to work and each time he changes his employment instead of only when he first goes to work, as formerly. The definition of street trades is extended to include bootblacks as well as boys who deliver or peddle newspapers, the street trades law is limited to cities of 20,000 or over instead of being state-wide in application, street work is prohibited after 7 p. m. instead of after 8 p m., and proof of age and a physical examination are required before a boy may obtain a street-trades badge. The length of required attendance at day school is made 190 instead of 180 days, and in cities the board of education is given power to require minors 16 years of age to attend full-time day school if not employed. In one respect, however, the new law lowers the standard of the old, since it requires attendance at continuation school of minors up to 17 years of age instead of 18 as would have been required by September, 1928, under the former law. The localities in which continuation-school attendance is compulsory are changed from cities and districts with a population of 5,000 or more in which there are 200 or more employed minors under 16, to places with a population of 20,000 or more and school districts in which there are 200 or more employed minors under 17 years of age.

The Rhode Island Legislature passed three laws raising the standards of the child-labor legislation of that State. The maximum hours of labor for children under 16 in manufacturing, mechanical, and mercantile establishments were reduced from 10 per day and 54 per week to 9 per day and 48 per week. The night-work prohibition for children under 16 was made to begin at 7 p. m. instead of 8 p. m. The street trades law formerly applying only to Providence was extended to cover all cities of more than 40,000 inhabitants, so that it now applies to Pawtucket and Woonsocket in addition to Providence.

A compulsory school attendance bill was passed by the South Carolina Legislature and is now in the hands of the governor, who has until January 3, 1929, to decide whether he will sign it or veto it. If it becomes law the compulsory school age will extend from 7 to 14 instead of 8 to 14, and attendance will be required for the full term; now attendance is required only for four consecutive months, or 80 school days.

In Virginia the new school code passed this year makes the age period during which attendance is required begin at 7 instead of 8

years of age and end at 15 instead of 14 years of age. The local school board, after a public hearing, may make this attendance period between 8 and 16 instead of between 7 and 15 years of age. Counties or cities without adequate buildings for enforcement of the law are allowed two years to make provision for carrying it out; further extension of time may be granted by the city or county tax-levying authorities in their discretion. The provision in the former law allowing school boards, with the concurrence of the board of supervisors or the governing body of the county or city, to except the county or city from the provisions of the law is eliminated.

Reports have been received of a number of attempted advances in the standards of State child labor and compulsory school attendance laws which failed of enactment, but information with regard to these bills is incomplete. The unsuccessful proposals of this type reported to the bureau are: In Kentucky, a bill to fix a penalty for violation of the compulsory school attendance law higher than that in the bill which passed; in Louisiana, a bill to reduce hours of labor for minors between 16 and 18 years of age and for women from 10 per day and 60 per week to 8 per day and 48 per week; in Massachusetts, a bill to raise the minimum age for employment of children; in New Jersey, bills to prevent the employment of migratory child workers during the time when the laws of their own State would require their attendance at school, to penalize employers failing to safeguard machinery after notification by the department of labor by subjecting them to the payment of double compensation to employees injured because of such failure, to reduce hours of labor in bakeries, and to strengthen the night work law for females; in New York, bills providing for a minimum-wage board to study wages paid to women and minors and recommend a living wage, relating to vocational and educational guidance of minors, establishing a division of research in the State department of education, eliminating exemptions to the 8-hour law for females, amending the compensation law so as to raise the wage basis for awarding compensation to minor workers, providing for a State medical inspector with assistants in connection with a program of medical inspection of pupils attending part-time or continuation schools, and extending the list of articles of which the manufacture in tenements is forbidden; in Rhode Island, bills to provide one day of rest in seven for workers in manufacturing and mercantile establishments and to provide a maximum 45-hour week and 9-hour day for all employees in manufacturing, mechanical, business, and mercantile establishments (a bill for a 9-hour day and 48-hour week for minors under 16 in such establishments, however, passed).

A few reports have been received of bills attempting to lower existing standards, which failed to pass. These are: In Massachusetts, a bill to permit the employment of women in textile mills after 6 p. m.; in New York, a number of bills reducing from 18 to 16 the age for compulsory attendance at continuation school or permitting the substitution of evening-school attendance for attendance at day continuation school (the education law which was passed reduced the age to 17 but added no exemptions), and a bill exempting females 16 years of age and over employed in restaurants from the hours of labor and night work law.

In some States administrative authorities have power to make rulings or orders in regard to child labor which have the effect of law. In California, New York, and Pennsylvania orders of this kind were put into effect. In California the department of industrial relations ruled that children under 16 should not be permitted to work in close proximity to moving machinery, on building or construction work, or in delivering goods, merchandise, papers, or packages from motor vehicles. In New York the industrial board adopted rulings prohibiting the employment of minors under 16 and of minors between 16 and 18 years of age in the operation of machines not guarded in a prescribed manner. The Industrial Board of Pennsylvania prohibited the employment of children under 16 on power-driven meat-grinding machines.

Public aid to dependent children in their own homes.

Kentucky and Mississippi enacted laws authorizing public aid to mothers with dependent children, so that 44 States and the District of Columbia have now provided for this method of keeping dependent children with their mothers. A bill providing for the establishment of a system of mothers' aid was introduced in South Carolina, but did not pass. No State funds are available for mothers' aid in either Kentucky or Mississippi, the counties being authorized to grant the necessary amount. The Kentucky mothers' aid provision is part of an act which abolished the child-welfare commission, and created in its place a State children's bureau with an appropriation of $5,000 a year for the ensuing biennium. The bill as originally introduced called for an appropriation of $10,000 per year for the bureau and $35,000 as a State fund for allowances. Under the law as passed counties are authorized to levy a tax to provide the necessary funds, and county children's bureaus, authorized by this act, make investigations before granting allowances. The Mississippi act authorizes the board of supervisors in each county to set aside out of the poor fund or the county general fund a "children's aid fund" for the purpose of providing home care and maintenance and support for dependent and needy children. Aid is payable upon order of the chancery court. The act requires investigations of applications by the court, and visitation and reports after allowances are granted.

In New Jersey the amount of aid authorized under its law was increased, the new maximum amounts being $16 a month for one child under 16 years of age, $30 a month for two such children, and $12 a month for each additional child under such age.

Louisiana amended the law relating to aid to mothers with dependent children by making it optional with parishes and municipalities, instead of mandatory, to provide funds for this purpose.

In New York bills which did not become law would have provided for State contribution to mothers' aid funds and would have extended the benefits of the law to classes not now covered by it. A Rhode Island bill which did not pass would have extended the mothers' aid law to alien mothers under certain specified conditions.

Other State and local public-welfare measures.

Kentucky amended the law creating a State board of charities and corrections for the purpose of unifying and clarifying the laws relating to that department, and New York amended a number of

articles of the State charities law. In New York a new public welfare law was proposed, to replace the present poor laws and related statutes and to provide for a permissive system of county administration throughout the State. The bill passed the senate unanimously but was not reported by the assembly committee. Porto Rico established the insular commission of public charity to study the medical-assistance features of the system of public charity in the island and recommend reforms to the legislature at its 1929 session.

In Massachusetts the poor-relief laws were amended so as to eliminate the word "pauper" from the statutes, and to change "overseers of the poor" to "board of public welfare" and "almshouse" to "infirmary." New Jersey increased from $6 to $12 per week the amount authorized which may be paid for maintaining children in incorporated charitable institutions. Another New Jersey act requires counties to levy in the year 1929 a tax of one-half mill on all property on which municipal taxes are levied for a State institution construction fund, to be used for State charitable and correctional institutions.

Juvenile courts and probation.

In New York the special juvenile-court laws for Buffalo and Syracuse were amended. The New York State division of probation was made one of the statutory divisions of the department of correction with general supervision over the administration of probation throughout the State, including probation in children's courts. Another New York law requires that before any person is placed on probation the court shall consider his social history, previous court record, and the circumstances of the offense, and that in case of a felony the district attorney shall be given an opportunity to be heard before sentence is suspended or the defendant placed on probation.

In New Jersey bills providing for the establishment by popular vote of juvenile and domestic-relations courts in other than first-class counties (which already have such courts), these courts to have exclusive jurisdiction over children's cases and to use chancery or civil procedure in such cases, and bills coordinating and strengthening the probation laws were sponsored by the juvenile and probation study commission created by the 1927 legislature but failed to pass.

Louisiana provided for a State industrial school for colored boys 17 years of age or under committed by the juvenile courts.

Offenses against children.

Kentucky increased the penalty for kidnaping, making it an offense punishable by death or life imprisonment, and New Jersey made 30 years' imprisonment the minimum punishment for such offense. New York provided that the consent of the person kidnaped shall not be a defense unless such person is over 16 years of age.

Nonsupport and illegitimacy.

New Jersey withdrew from justices of the peace jurisdiction over cases of nonsupport of wife and children or other proceedings for relief of the poor, providing that such cases shall be heard in the future by courts of common pleas and criminal courts of record, and assigned to the latter courts exclusive jurisdiction in illegitimacy cases. Administrative features of the nonsupport and illegitimacy laws of New York were strengthened. A Kentucky bill which was not passed would have extended the provisions of the nonsupport law to children under 16 years, instead of under 14 as at present.

Compensation to prisoners' families.

Massachusetts authorized the establishment of a system of compensation for inmates of the State prison, the Massachusetts reformatory, and the reformatory for women, to be paid out of the profit from prison industries. One-half of the amounts so earned by prisoners may be paid to their dependents monthly, or at other intervals to be established by rules and regulations. Kentucky failed to pass a bill which would have required the board of charities and corrections to set aside to the credit of inmates of the reformatory or the penitentiary at least 30 cents a day from the prisoner's wages, such amount to be sent to his dependents at the end of each month.

Adoption and guardianship.

Kentucky enacted a law providing that the mother and father are equally entitled to the services and earnings of a minor child. New Jersey amended the law relating to guardians of minors, granting to mothers and fathers equal rights to dispose of their children by will with the consent of the other parent. In New York bills amending the adoption and guardianship laws were proposed but not enacted, and a New Jersey bill relating to the custody rights of a nonsupporting father failed to pass.

Physically handicapped children.

New Jersey passed six new laws affecting the welfare of physically handicapped children. The crippled children's commission created in 1926 was continued, with an authorized appropriation of $5,000. It is to submit recommendations to the 1929 legislature. The membership of the State commission for the rehabilitation of physically handicapped persons was increased from three to five. The two additional members, one of whom must be a woman, are to be chosen because of their special interest in crippled children and knowledge of methods used in their care, treatment, and education. The term "physically handicapped" was amended to include those incapacitated for education as well as those incapacitated for remunerative occupation, and the limitation to persons over 16 years of age was removed. A third New Jersey act authorizes counties having no county home or hospital for the treatment and care of crippled children to assist in maintaining such institutions in the county, and to defray the expenses of diagnosis, investigation, treatment, care, and maintenance of crippled children under 21 in private homes and hospitals in any county of the State. State aid was also granted to local school districts providing special classes or home teaching for crippled children. The New Jersey education law authorizing special facilities for the care, physical restoration, and instruction of physically handicapped children was amended in a number of respects so as to provide, among other things, for home teaching, transportation, and maintenance of such children while in attendance at special classes in other than their home districts, and for the establishment of special classes in any hospital, convalescent home, or institution where there are at least eight physically handicapped children. Boards of education are required under a new provision to maintain a register of all physically handicapped persons under 21 years of age. Copies of this list are to be furnished at least annually to the commissioner of education, who in turn furnishes

copies of the State register to the commission for the rehabilitation of physically handicapped persons. Another New Jersey law requires the physician, midwife, or person acting as midwife at the birth of any child with visible congenital deformities to report such condition to the State rehabilitation commission within 30 days after birth.

Kentucky authorized boards of education in cities of the first class to provide for the transportation to and from public schools of crippled children and of other children for whom the board after investigation deems it necessary. Massachusetts required deaf children between 7 and 18 years of age, with certain exceptions, to attend some school for the deaf approved by the department of education. Louisiana did not pass a bill for compulsory school attendance of blind or partly blind children between 6 and 21 years. In New York the powers of the Chautauqua County court with reference to physical and mental examination and care of handicapped children were enlarged.

Mentally defective children.

No legislation relating specifically to mentally defective children is known to have been enacted, but Mississippi passed a law authorizing sterilization of inmates of State institutions for the insane and feeble-minded. In New York bills to create a bureau of psychiatric instruction in the department of education and to authorize sterilization of mental defectives in institutions receiving State funds were not reported out of committee. In Louisiana a bill authorizing sterilization of inmates of State and city institutions for mental defectives was not passed.

Child hygiene and public health.

A New Jersey law requiring private nursing homes to be licensed was amended so as to make this licensing provision apply also to private hospitals. Rhode Island authorized two or more towns to unite in the employment of a health officer. Porto Rico established in the department of education a division of child hygiene with a physician as director.

Marriage of minors.

Kentucky raised the minimum marriage age of boys from 14 to 16 years and of girls from 12 to 14 years. New Jersey authorized the annulment of marriages contracted by girls under 18 years of age and not ratified after reaching this age. Formerly this was permitted for boys under 18 but for girls under 16 only. Owing to an error in the New York marriage bill passed in 1927 requiring proof of age, the prohibition of marriages of boys under 16 and girls under 14 was repealed. At the 1928 session this provision was restored. A New York bill requiring written consent of a children's court judge to the marriage of girls between 14 and 16 years passed the senate but not the assembly.

A Louisiana bill to prohibit the marriage of insane, feeble-minded, or venereally diseased persons, to create a State hygienic marriage board, and to require physical examination of applicants for a marriage license did not become a law.

New Jersey did not pass a bill providing that clerks issuing licenses contrary to the provisions of the marriage act and appli-

ants for a marriage license or identifying witnesses making false statement should be subject to a penalty of $100 for the first offense and $200 for each subsequent offense.

Recreation.

Bills relating to recreation were introduced in New York and Rhode Island, but the New York bills did not pass. In Rhode Island the law that prohibited the admission of boys under 14 and girls under 16 to motion-picture theaters unless accompanied by an adult was amended so as to prohibit the admission of any child under 15 unless accompanied by a person 18 years of age or over, except that attendance of children over 10 and under 15 is permitted outside school hours and between the hours of 9 a. m. and 7 p. m.

Of the New York bills that were not passed one would have repealed the law creating the motion-picture division of the department of education, and another would have authorized cities of less than 1,000,000 inhabitants and towns and villages to adopt ordinances regulating the attendance of children at motion-picture houses. Other New York bills proposed to authorize the establishment of camp departments by local boards of child welfare, for the vacation care of children between 10 and 14 years of age, and the creation of a temporary commission to examine the advisability and practicability of the State's establishing free camps for boys and girls.

EXHIBITS

During the year 355 shipments of exhibit material were sent to National, State, and local agencies, including the American Medical Association and other medical societies, public-health services, boards of health, child-welfare societies, fraternal societies, educational institutions, Young Men's and Young Women's Christian Associations, The American Red Cross, Boy Scout Troops, Camp Fire Girls, women's clubs, State and county fairs, and social-service organizations. This material included 3,795 panels, 485 reels of motion-picture film, 1,766 slides and 30 film strips for still projectors, 14 models, and 4 projectors. Reports from approximately 75 per cent of the borrowers show an attendance of 382,000 at the motion pictures and 529,000 persons at the other exhibits—an average of 76,000 persons reached each month by the exhibits of the bureau.

A one-reel motion picture, The Best-Fed Baby, was produced during the year to illustrate the advantages of breast feeding over artificial feeding. In the preparation of the scenario and the production of the film the bureau staff had the cooperation of the New York State Board of Health through the director of its division of maternity, infancy, and child hygiene, and the special assistance of one of its consultants who is a well-known pediatrist. Advice was also given by a pediatrist from Oregon who is an authority on breast feeding. The film was reviewed at the conference of State directors of maternity and infancy work before being released.

At the request of the American Medical Association, the Children's Bureau cooperated with that organization during the year in the preparation of a special set of posters on the care of the baby. Photographs and text were supplied by the bureau for these posters, which were reproduced in color by the American Medical Association. The posters will be distributed by both organizations.

REPORTS ISSUED, IN PRESS, AND IN PREPARATION

During the fiscal year 1928, 35 new and revised publications were issued. Eleven were in press at the close of the fiscal year and 20 in preparation.

Reports issued during the fiscal year ended June 30, 1928:

Fifteenth Annual Report of the Chief, Children's Bureau, 1927.

The Promotion of the Welfare and Hygiene of Maternity and Infancy—The Administration of the Act of Congress of November 23, 1921, for Fiscal Year Ended June 30, 1926. No. 178.

Proceedings of the Fourth Annual Conference of State Directors in Charge of the Local Administration of the Maternity and Infancy Act of November 23, 1921. No. 181.

- Separate No. 1. The Problem of Compulsory Notification of Puerperal Septicemia, by George Clark Mosher, M. D.
- Separate No. 2. The County Health Organization in Relation to Maternity and Infancy Work and Its Permanency, by John A. Ferrell, M. D.
- Separate No. 3. Evaluation of Maternity and Infancy Work in a Generalized Program, by Jessie L. Marriner, R. N.
- Separate No. 4. Breast-Feeding Demonstrations, by Frank Howard Richardson, M. D.
- Separate No. 5. Foundation for Permanent Child-Hygiene Program in New Hampshire, by Elena M. Crough, R. N.
- Separate No. 6. Standards for Training of Public-Health Nurses, by Elizabeth Fox.

Child Management, by D. A. Thom, M. D. (revised September, 1927). No. 143.

References on the Physical Growth and Development of the Normal Child. No. 179.

Child Welfare in New Jersey, Part 4—Local Provision for Dependent and Delinquent Children in Relation to the State's Program. No. 180.

The Children's Bureau of Cleveland. by Mary Mather Leete. No. 177.

Public Aid to Mothers with Dependent Children; extent and fundamental principles, by Emma O. Lundberg. (Revised.) No. 162.

Welfare of Prisoners' Families in Kentucky, by Ruth S. Bloodgood. No. 182.

Dodgers, folders, leaflets, and posters issued during the fiscal year ended June 30, 1928:

Keeping the Well Baby Well. Folder No. 9.

What Is Happening to Mothers and Babies in the District of Columbia?, by Dorothy Reed Mendenhall, M. D.

Is Your Child's Birth Recorded? Revised October 15, 1927, and March 15, 1928. Dodger No. 3.

Transverse Lines in X-Ray Plates of the Long Bones of Children, by Martha M. Eliot, M. D., Susan P. Souther, M. D., and E. A. Park, M. D. (Reprinted from Bulletin of the Johns Hopkins Hospital, vol. 41, no. 6 (December, 1927), pp. 364–388).

Lesson Material on Care of the Preschool Child:

- No. 1. Your Child's Health Examination.
- No. 2. Your Child's Physical Defects.
- No. 3. Your Child's Teeth.
- No. 4. Your Child's Nutrition.
- No. 5. Your Child's Food Likes and Dislikes.
- No. 6. Your Child's Posture.
- No. 7. Your Child's Need of Sunshine and Open Air.
- No. 8. Your Child's Behavior.
- No. 9. Protecting Your Child against Communicable Diseases.
- References on Prenatal, Infant, and Child Care, and Child Management.

Newspaper Sellers in Washington, D. C. (Separate from Publication No. 183, Children in Street Work, by Nettie P. McGill.)

Alcoholism among Parents of Juvenile Delinquents, by Alice Channing. (Reprinted from The Social Service Review, vol. 1, no. 3 (September, 1927).)

The Extent of Child Dependency and Delinquency in Seven Pennsylvania Counties. (Revised.) (Separate from Publication No. 176, Child-Welfare Conditions and Resources in Seven Pennsylvania Counties, by Neva R. Deardorff, Ph. D.)
El Bienestar del Niño. (Papers presented by delegates of the United States to the Fifth Pan American Child Congress.)
John and Elsie posters. (A set of 13 posters showing child-labor standards.)
List of Publications, January 3, 1928.

Reports in press at the close of the fiscal year ended June 30, 1928:

The Children's Bureau (leaflet).[19]
The Promotion of the Welfare and Hygiene of Maternity and Infancy—The Administration of the Act of Congress of November 23, 1921, for Fiscal Year Ended June 30, 1927.[19]
Child Labor in New Jersey, Part 2—Children Engaged in Industrial Home Work.[20]
Child Workers on City Streets.
Children in Agriculture.
Children in Street Work.[21]
State Laws and Local Ordinances Regulating the Street Work of Children. (Chart No. 15.)
Administration of Mothers' Aid in Ten Localities, with Special Reference to Health, Housing, Education, and Recreation.[20]
Analysis and Tabular Summary of State Laws Relating to Illegitimacy in the United States in Effect January 1, 1928, and the Texts of Selected Laws.
Children of Illegitimate Birth Whose Mothers Have Kept Their Custody.
Public Dance Halls—Their Regulation and Place in the Recreation of Adolescents.

Reports in preparation at the close of the fiscal year ended June 30, 1928:

Sixteenth Annual Report of the Chief, Children's Bureau, 1928.
Proceedings of the Fifth Annual Conference of State Directors in Charge of the Local Administration of the Maternity and Infancy Act of November 23, 1921.
The Promotion of the Welfare and Hygiene of Maternity and Infancy—The Administration of the Act of Congress of November 23, 1921, for Fiscal Year Ended June 30, 1928.
Folders and leaflets—
  Care of the Preschool Child.
  Lesson Material on Infant Care.
  Lesson Material on Prenatal Care.
  Why Sleep?
The Incidence of Rickets among Children in Porto Rico.
The Incidence of Rickets among a Group of Children under Four Years of Age in Washington, D. C.
Relation of Posture to Physical Fitness.
Child Labor in Canneries.
Child Labor in New Jersey, Part 1—Employment of School Children.
Child Labor in New Jersey, Part 3—Continuation—School Children of Newark and Paterson.
The Trend of Child Labor in 1927.
The Child, the Family, and the Court; a study of the administration of justice in the field of domestic relations: Part 1, General Findings and Recommendations; Part 2, Organization and Administration of Family Courts.
Child Welfare in New Jersey, Part 3—State Provision for Institutional Care of Delinquent Children.
Child Welfare in Selected Counties in Washington.
Courts Having Jurisdiction in Children's Cases and Cases of Domestic Relations. (Chart No. 17.)
Institutional Care of Juvenile Delinquents.
Youth and Crime in Chicago; a study of the prevalence and treatment of delinquency among boys above juvenile-court age.

[19] Issued in September, 1928.
[20] Issued Aug. 20, 1928.
[21] Issued July 7, 1928.

FOREIGN RESEARCH

The bureau has conducted general current research, listing acquisitions to the department library and reading a selected list of periodicals, English and foreign. It has maintained a foreign-language research and translating service, which has involved reading and summarizing of child-welfare material in various foreign languages. Some of the subjects on which information has been obtained during the year are: Neonatal, maternal, and infant mortality statistics of a number of foreign countries; rickets; child welfare in Latin-American countries for the use of delegates to the Fifth Pan American Child Congress held in Habana, December 8–13, 1927; material on social work for dependent children for the International Child Welfare Congress, Paris, July 8–12, 1928; dependent children in Europe and Latin America; child-labor provisions of foreign countries.

DISTRIBUTION OF PUBLICATIONS

The number of publications distributed during the past year was 1,432,858, an increase of 126,794 over the preceding year. The distribution of the popular bulletins on the care of children was as follows:

	1927	1928
Child Care	60,520	144,519
Child Management	63,912	48,573
Infant Care	335,235	419,950
Prenatal Care	166,399	159,797

This statement showing increases in distribution for some and decreases for other bulletins is not a measure of the demand. The bureau has never been able to meet all requests for these bulletins. Quantity allotments are made to State and municipal departments of health, to Congressmen who make a practice of sending them to lists of mothers of newborn infants obtained from registrars of vital statistics in their districts, and so far as possible to health agencies such as the Red Cross and infant-welfare and district nursing associations. These allotments, however, have been only a fraction of the numbers requested. A number sufficient to meet individual requests of mothers must be kept in reserve. The decrease in the number of copies of Child Management distributed in 1928 was due to the fact that the publication was out of print for two months. A special appropriation for Infant Care permitted a somewhat more generous consideration of requests for quantities of this bulletin. Child Care was out of print the greater part of 1927, but was again available during the year under review. The distribution of dodgers, folders, and charts brings the total number of popular publications distributed to mothers to 1,262,431. As the interest in parental education grows the demand for the bureau's popular bulletins, folders, and charts continues to increase, even though a large amount of material is now available through State and municipal departments of public health and other agencies.

The bureau has been unable, also, to meet the demand for its technical publications. The issuing of small editions and the curtailment of distribution by circularization of the mailing lists were continued.

Letters containing money for the purchase of publications have been referred to the Superintendent of Documents as heretofore. The sales of the four popular bulletins by the Superintendent of Documents amounted to 280,000 in 1927, and the number ordered for sale in 1928 was 297,000.

The Child Welfare News Summary was issued twenty-nine times during the year. On July 1, 1927, there were 1,148 names on the mailing list; during the year 63 names have been added. The Summary is sent, on request only, to persons who are actively engaged in child-welfare work and to child-welfare agencies and publications. The list was in process of revision at the end of the fiscal year.

COOPERATION WITH CHILD-WELFARE MOVEMENTS IN OTHER COUNTRIES

Pan American child welfare.

The Fifth Pan American Child Congress, the first to be held within convenient distance of the United States, met in Habana, Cuba, from December 8 to December 13, 1927. It was attended by 14 delegates designated by the Department of State and 5 unofficial representatives of organizations in the United States. The United States delegation, official and unofficial, included representatives of three Federal bureaus—the Children's Bureau, the Bureau of Education, and the Public Health Service—of the State of Indiana, of the Territory of Porto Rico, and of 10 private nation-wide organizations. Many of these organizations and several others contributed to the child-welfare exhibit held in connection with the congress. The participation of so representative a delegation can not fail to result in greatly increased cooperation between the children's workers of North America and those of South America.

Official delegates from 14 American countries attended the congress. It was divided into six sections—medicine, hygiene, education, sociology, psychology, and legislation. As a result of the deliberations a number of resolutions, covering practically all the subjects considered, were adopted. The resolutions commended the inauguration of the International American Institute for the Protection of Childhood in Montevideo, recommended that laws for the protection of childhood be enacted and that child-welfare laws be harmonized, and outlined in some detail the organization of juvenile courts. Many other subjects were covered by the resolutions, including the following: Rest before and after childbirth, prenatal care, child hygiene, psychological clinics, educational institutions for children of preschool age, courses in child care in the schools, parental education, visiting teachers, character education, training of social workers, prevention and treatment of juvenile delinquency, investigation of paternity, institutions for children, changes in marriage laws, and limitation of the liquor traffic. The Sixth Pan American Child Congress will be held in Lima, Peru.

The International American Institute for the Protection of Childhood, an outgrowth of the child congresses, has been functioning since July, 1927, with headquarters in Montevideo. It is to serve as a Pan American center of research, consultation, and education in child-welfare matters. A valuable quarterly bulletin is published, of which four numbers have been issued. Membership of

the United States in the institute was authorized by act of Congress approved May 3, 1928. This act authorizes an annual appropriation of $2,000 per annum for the contribution by the United States toward the support of the institution. The Government of Uruguay has just appropriated $30,000 in addition to its annual membership fee, to be expended over a three-year period. It is to be hoped that the American funds made available by Congress may be supplemented by private gifts from the United States, so that the institute may have adequate resources for the task it has undertaken.

The Child-Welfare Commission of the League of Nations.

The Chief of the Children's Bureau, who serves in a consultative capacity as the American member of the Commission on the Welfare of Children and Young Persons of the League of Nations, was not able to attend the March sessions of the commission, but material on child-welfare legislation in the United States and other reports have been supplied the commission as requested.

GENERAL DEVELOPMENT OF THE WORK OF THE BUREAU

The Children's Bureau was created to serve as a central bureau of information, research, and consultation so that unnecessary experimenting with the lives of children might be reduced to a minimum and the experience of each made available to all.

In 1921 the well-established principle of Federal aid was utilized to promote the health of mothers and babies, and the Children's Bureau was intrusted with the administration of this important measure. That Federal interest in this field was approved by the States is indicated in the acceptance of the maternity and infancy act by all but three States and the resolutions adopted by the Association of State and Provincial Health Officers, which declare that the administration of the act has quickened local interest and promoted local responsibility. This act, which comes to an end June 30, 1929, has served its purpose in demonstrating the usefulness of Federal, State, and local cooperation in the promotion of the health of children. In some States the work will go forward, although less rapidly, should the Federal Government adhere to the policy of complete withdrawal; but in a larger number the time and resources available have not been adequate to make more than a beginning in the initiation of a statewide program, so that the health of mothers and babies is certain to suffer if such a policy is followed.

In previous reports attention has been called to the importance of greatly increasing the resources of the Children's Bureau for investigation and consultation on request in methods of preventing delinquency. In recent years there has been much concern about crime and lawlessness in the United States. State and National commissions and associations have surveyed the situation. Some important recommendations have been made as to the improvement of criminal-court methods and the treatment of criminals, but all of them have pointed out that prevention must begin with the children. There is no single cause of the development of antisocial tendencies in children. There is no single remedy. The subject calls for continuing scientific research in problems and methods of treatment. The bureau has ex-

cellent working relationships with the agencies dealing with delinquents, and its assistance and cooperation are desired. We can only repeat, to delay in making possible the employment of the necessary experts by the bureau for this work is costly economy.

The United States has been very slow in the accumulation of the basic facts about children, except in a limited sense. We do not know the numbers of dependent, delinquent, feeble-minded, and crippled children in the United States or the number of children who go to work each year. Some progress is being made: The vital-statistics division of the Bureau of the Census can now tell us how many children are born and die in most States; the Children's Bureau has inaugurated a plan for uniform reporting of juvenile-court statistics, which has had a most encouraging reception; and the annual reporting to the bureau of the work permits issued to children is being undertaken by a considerably increased number of States and cities this year. All this work needs to be extended. A plan for uniform reporting of the facts with reference to dependency should be inaugurated. But money is needed for presenting the plans to the agencies, for printing schedules, and for tabulating and printing the findings.

If there is any subject endowed with national interest it is the welfare of the Nation's children. The Nation's future existence, the intelligent use of its resources, the rôle it will play in world affairs depend on its children—whether or not they are physically fit and whether or not they are trained in self-control, in respect for the rights of others, and in understanding of their own rights and obligations. That the first responsibility must rest with the nearest government—the State, the county, and the municipality—is the reason why the rôle that the Federal Government must play in the training of children is that of an intelligent and interested cooperator, ready to assist but not to control nor hamper.

Respectfully submitted.

GRACE ABBOTT, *Chief.*

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